



**Revised Constitution and Bylaws of the
Women's Missionary Society of the
African Methodist Episcopal Church**

FOREWORD

This revised Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church was approved at the 2023 Quadrennial Convention and ratified at the 52nd Quadrennial Session of the General Conference.

Special thanks to the 2023 Constitution and Bylaws Revision and Compilation Committee for their exceptional work. Committee members, under the Connectional leadership of President Dr. Deborah Taylor King, consisted of: Chair, Harriet Brown Birk, Esquire, Dr. Delores Kennedy Williams (5th), Dr. Shirley Hopkins Davis (8th), and Dr. Shirley Cason Reed (9th). Much appreciation to Supervisor Dr. Dorothy Jackson Young, Ms. Wanda Ringgold and Ms. Wanda Sims.

The Work is ALL DIVINE!

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**Constitution and Bylaws
Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Constitution**

Article I - Name

Section 1. **Name.** The name of this organization shall be the Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Section 2. **Designations.** For the purposes of this constitution and accompanying bylaws, the African Methodist Episcopal Church is designated as "A.M.E. Church" or the "church"; Women's Missionary Society as the "Connectional", "Connectional organization", or "Connectional Society"; Episcopal Women's Missionary Society as the "Episcopal", "Episcopal District", "Episcopal organization" or "Episcopal Level"; Conference Women's Missionary Society as the "Conference", "Conference organization" or "Conference Level"; Area Women's Missionary Society as the "Area Level", and Local Women's Missionary Society as the "Local", "Local Society", "Local organization" or "Local Level."

Article II - Mission Statement and Purpose

Section 1. **Mission Statement.** We are *called* to strengthen our faith and *sent* to continue the ministry of Jesus Christ by service and witness in the world.

Section 2. **Purpose.** As women *called* to discipleship to grow in knowledge and experience of God through Jesus Christ, *committed* to support the mission of the church, and, *empowered* by the Holy Spirit, we are *challenged* to help one another engage in ministry and action, and grow and respond in faith to God's redemptive plan for the church, the society, and the world. To accomplish our purpose, the organization shall:

- a. Coordinate and unify the work of our mission structure, by establishing and supporting organizations and units to carry out God's mission in the church, the society and the world;
- b. Build an intergenerational community of caring women *among* all levels of the WMS and other women's organizations that can work collaboratively, ecumenically, and globally on peace, justice, and human rights issues;
- c. Provide training and education that develop and inspire responsible and visionary leadership that is motivated to witness or advocate for the global mission community, and advocate for peace, justice, and human rights for women, children, elderly, and families;
- d. Provide for flexible structures, so that groups may determine the structure and programs most appropriate and workable in their church;
- e. Develop and distribute written, printed, and electronic resources and periodicals and maintain an archival database and repository of information for the organization;
- f. Develop networks for communication within the organization and among women ecumenically and globally; and
- g. Develop and maintain a comprehensive financial support system for the organization and administration of financial resources necessary for the fulfillment of the responsibilities and mission of the organization.

Article III - Authority

Section 1. **Policies**. The organization shall take such steps as needed to realize its mission and purpose. It shall function within the policies of the A.M.E. Church and this constitution and bylaws.

Section 2. **Responsibilities**. The organization shall have and may exercise all powers assigned to nonprofit corporations by the District of Columbia except as limited by the constitution and bylaws of this organization and *The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*.

Article IV - Structure and Operational Framework

Section 1. **Organizational Structure**. This organization shall be a church wide organization that shall function through Connectional, Episcopal, Conference and Local bodies. Each group shall seek to function interdependently and shall recognize it is in a partnership relationship with the others to share in God's mission.

- a. The Episcopal organizations shall have numbers and boundaries that coincide with those established by the A.M.E. Church. Each Episcopal organization shall provide for Conferences consistent with those established by the A.M.E. Church.
- b. A Conference shall consist of all Local organizations within the boundaries of the Conference. Upon a determination by a Conference organization that Areas are necessary for the efficient conduct of its business, the Conference may establish Areas in accordance with the bylaws.
- c. A single congregation may establish a Local organization (Society), or two or more congregations without a Local organization may form an intercongregational Local organization. A single congregation with a Local organization (Society), but without a sufficient number of members to fully organize, may form an intercongregational Local organization with one or more other congregations.
- d. For each Women's Missionary Society organization created, there shall also be created and provided a Young People's and Children's Division.

Section 2. **Quadrennial Convention**. The Quadrennial Convention shall fulfill the legislative function of the organization as described in this organization's constitution, bylaws, and resolutions.

Section 3. **Executive Board**. There shall be established an Executive Board. The Executive Board shall exercise interim legislative authority during a quadrennial. The composition and duties of the Executive Board shall be set forth in the bylaws.

"Interim Legislative Authority" means that between meetings of the Quadrennial Convention, the Executive Board may exercise the authority of the Quadrennial Convention so long as:

- a. The actions of the Executive Board do not conflict with the actions of and policies established by the Quadrennial Convention; and
- b. The Quadrennial Convention is not precluded by constitutional provisions from taking action on the matter.

Section 4. **Decision-making Bodies**. The leadership of the organization shall be vested in the elected officers, members of the Quadrennial Convention and Executive Board, and members of the Commission on Administration.

Section 5. **Commissions; Committees**. The organization shall consist of commissions as set forth in the bylaws. The Young People's and Children's Division shall consist of standing committees as set forth in the bylaws of the Young People's and Children's Division. Each organization may establish such task forces or special committees as it deems necessary to carry out the purpose and functions of each organization.

Section 6. **Connectional Treasury; Management of Funds**. This organization shall be financed through a single treasury and the organization's fiscal year shall be in accordance with the fiscal year of the A.M.E. Church.

Article V - Membership

The membership of this organization shall be comprised of all women of the church, except women who are itinerant elders, who are in good and regular standing in their Local organizations. Voting and other memberships shall be as provided in Articles III and V of the bylaws, unless otherwise provided herein.

Article VI - Quadrennial Convention

Section 1. **Convention Authority**. The Quadrennial Convention shall be the highest legislative authority of the organization and shall deal with all matters that are necessary in the pursuit of the mission, purpose and functions of this organization. Powers of the Quadrennial Convention are only limited by the Quadrennial Convention's own resolutions and *The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*.

Section 2. **Quadrennial and Special Conventions**. The **Connectional WMS and YPD** shall meet quadrennially the year preceding the General Conference of the A.M.E. Church, at such time and place to be recommended by the **WMS** President and approved by the Executive Board **not to exceed seven (7) days for both conventions**. Special Conventions shall be called by the **WMS** President of the organization at the written request of at least two-thirds of the Convention.

Section 3. **Voting Members of the Quadrennial Convention**. The voting members of the Quadrennial Convention shall consist of the elected delegates, elected Connectional officers, past and present Episcopal Supervisors, past Connectional Presidents, Episcopal and Conference Presidents, Episcopal and Conference Directors of the Young People's and Children's Division and Life Members.

Section 4. **Committees of the Quadrennial Convention**. The committees of the Quadrennial Convention shall be the Program Committee, Rules Committee, Credentials Committee, Memorial Committee, Constitution and Bylaws Committee, and the Nominating Committee. Members of the committees shall be appointed by the President. The duties and description of the committees shall be provided for in the Connectional Bylaws. Other committees may be authorized as the President shall deem necessary.

Article VII - Officers

Section 1. **Elected Officers**. The elected officers of the organization shall be the: President, First Vice President, Second Vice President, Third Vice President, Recording Secretary, Assistant

Recording Secretary, Corresponding Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Historiographer-Statistician, Editor of the Magazine, Associate Editor, Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, Parliamentarian, Worship Director and Member- At-Large.

The connectional officers shall be elected by the Quadrennial Convention, as provided by the bylaws.

Section 2. **Terms; Qualifications; Limitations.** The terms, qualifications to hold office and limitations of elected officers shall be provided for in the bylaws.

Article VIII - Headquarter Offices of The Women's Missionary Society

The organization shall establish and maintain an office designated as its headquarters office.

Article IX - Employment of Staff

This organization shall have the authority to employ staff and engage consultants in contractual arrangements in accordance with the constitution, bylaws and personnel practices of the organization.

Article X - Foundation of Women's Missionary Society

Section 1. **Authorized.** The organization may establish a Foundation to conduct and provide programs for major gifts, planned giving and deferred giving, investment opportunities and other means to create financial support for the organization to enhance and uphold its programs and ministries. The Foundation is a separate, private entity and shall be managed by a Board of Trustees.

- a. As a form of planned giving and to create consistent and sustaining financial support to the WMS Foundation, to expand and assist its various ministries, all members of the Women's Missionary Society shall be encouraged to pay annual WMS Foundation membership dues.
- b. Membership dues in the amount of \$5 (Districts 1-13) and \$1 (Districts 14-20) shall be paid by December 31 each year.
- c. Membership cards will be received by those who pay the membership dues.

Section 2. **Responsibilities.** The duties of the Board of Trustees of the Foundation shall include, but not be limited to, the following:

- a. Identify and cultivate prospective major and deferred gift donors;
- b. Initiate efforts to work in collaboration with other philanthropic organizations, nonprofits, the public sector and business;
- c. Seek gifts, bequests and investments for the organization;
- d. Preserve, manage and grow financial assets to provide a return and ongoing benefits to the organization; and
- e. Manage entrusted funds effectively and in socially responsible manner.

Section 3. **Board of Trustees.**

- a. *Composition of the Board.* The Foundation shall have a Board of Trustees consisting of at least twenty-five (25) but not more than thirty-six (36) members, and shall make every effort to compose the Board as follows:
 1. President of the organization;
 2. Treasurer of the organization;
 3. Three (3) Episcopal Supervisors, with at least one (1) of the Supervisors representing the 14th-20th Episcopal Districts;
 4. Members from the corporate or business community;
 5. Members with accounting backgrounds in non-profit corporations;
 6. Members with legal backgrounds in non-profit corporations;
 7. Members with investment expertise;
 8. Members with a public relations background;
 9. A representative of the Young Women, ages 18 -40 years; and
 10. Members-At-Large, consisting of an organizational member from each District, who has an interest and demonstrated abilities with foundations, grants, etc.
- b. *Election of Trustees; Terms.* The members of the Board who are Trustees by virtue of their being elected officers in the organization shall be confirmed by a majority vote of the Executive Board of the Women's Missionary Society. Members of the Board who are Trustees nominated from the Districts shall be elected by the Executive Board of the Women's Missionary Society. Members of the Board who are Trustees nominated based upon the various categories denoted in subsections 4-9 of Section 3a herein, shall be from among the 20 Members-At-Large nominated by the Districts.
 Any person conducting auditing and providing legal representation on behalf of the Board of Trustees shall not be a member of the Board.
 Each member shall serve for a term of four (4) years, but no more than eight (8) years. Upon the confirmation or election of the first members to the Board of Trustees, the Executive Board of the Women's Missionary Society shall stagger the terms of such members.
- c. *Trustees Costs and Expenses.* The meeting expenses and costs of the Trustees shall be paid by the Women's Missionary Society.
- d. *Preparation of Bylaws.* The first task of the initial Board of Trustees will be the development of its bylaws, which must be approved by the Executive Board of the Women's Missionary Society.

Section 4. **Reports; Audits.** An audit of the financial records of the Foundation shall be made biennially by a certified public accounting firm. The Foundation shall provide an annual financial report and report of its work and activities to the Executive Board.

Article XI – Sojourner Global Ministry Board

Section 1. **Authorized.** The organization may establish a Sojourner Global Ministry Board of Directors to provide overall policy and direction of the SG Ministry Program and to create means of financial support to enhance the program.

Section 2. **Responsibilities.** The duties of the Board of Directors of the Sojourner Global Ministry Program shall include, but not be limited to, the following:

- a. Set the overall policy and direction of the ministry;

- b. Initiate efforts to work through the WMS in collaboration with other non-profits, philanthropic organizations, and the public sector;
- c. Seek grant funds and donations for the Sojourner Global Ministry Program; and
- d. Manage entrusted funds effectively and in socially responsible manner.

Section 3. **Reports; Audits.** An audit of the financial records of the SGM Board shall be made biennially by a certified public accounting firm. The Board shall provide an annual financial report and report of its work and activities to the Executive Board.

Article XII – Operative Laws

The organization shall be governed by the *Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society, The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church* and *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*, the latest Edition.

Article XIII - Amendments and Bylaws

Section 1. **Amendments to Constitution.** The constitution of this organization may be amended through either of the following procedures:

- a. All proposed constitutional amendments coming from the Episcopal Districts, Conferences, and or Local Societies shall be received by the Constitution and Bylaws Committee no later than six (6) months before a Quadrennial Convention. The adoption of such an amendment shall require a two-thirds (2/3) vote of those delegates present and voting.
- b. All proposed amendments shall be provided to the Episcopal Supervisors and voting members by the Connectional Constitution and Bylaws Committee no later than ninety (90) days before the Quadrennial Convention.

Section 2. **Amendment of Bylaws.**

- a. All proposed amendments of bylaws coming from the Episcopal Districts, Conferences, and or Local Societies shall be received by the Constitution and Bylaws Committee no later than six (6) months before a Quadrennial Convention. The adoption of such an amendment shall require a two-thirds (2/3) vote of those delegates present and voting.
- b. All proposed amendments shall be provided to the Episcopal Supervisors and voting members by the Connectional Constitution and Bylaws Committee no later than ninety (90) days before the Quadrennial Convention.

Section 3. **Effective Date of Amendments.** Any amendments to this constitution and bylaws shall become effective at the conclusion of the General Conference ratifying the amendments.

Section 4. **Proposed Amendments.** No amendment shall be proposed to the constitution or bylaws if such amendment is in conflict with *Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*.

Article XIV – Correction of Scrivener's Errors

Upon adoption of amendments to this constitution or bylaws, the Revisions and Compilation Committee may correct punctuation, grammar, or numbering when appropriate, if the correction(s) does not change the meaning of the amendments.

**Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Connectional Bylaws**

Article I - Name

The name of this organization shall be the Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Article II – WMS as Non-Governmental Organization (NGO)

- Section 1. **Membership Status**. The representatives of the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) of the United Nations in Non-Governmental Organization Category II Status shall be members of the Women's Missionary Society.
- Section 2. **WMS Representatives**. The Society representatives to the United Nations shall be: The Connectional President, one (1) Main Representative; two (2) Alternate Representatives and one (1) Youth Representative, eighteen (18) to twenty-four (24) years old. One (1) year grounds passes may be issued to no more than the stated 4+1 formula as determined by the United Nations in its procedures and policies relative to NGOs as stated by the United Nation effective January 2011.
- Section 3. **Alternate/Youth Representatives**. The second (2nd) Alternate Representative (appointed by the President) and the Youth Representative may reside outside the New York City area. The Youth Representative will be appointed by the President in consultation with the Director of the Young People's and Children's Division.
- Section 4. **Terms of Appointment**. The representatives' terms of appointment shall be for a period of four (4) years, and they shall be eligible for reappointment at the will of the Connectional President.
- Section 5. **Liaisons**. The representatives shall serve as liaisons between the Executive Board of the Women's Missionary Society and the Economic and Social Council of the United Nations. They shall represent the Women's Missionary Society at the United Nations Non- Governmental Organizations meetings including relevant briefings and/or other conferences. The focus of the issues relevant to the Women's Missionary Society shall be women and children, health, human rights, peace, and justice and any other issues deemed relevant at the time.
- Section 6. **Responsibilities**. The representatives shall be responsible for gathering information from the briefings and conferences and forward such information to the Connectional President and in consultation, make decisions as to the dissemination of information and relevant programming and projects to be pursued. All required Annual and Quadrennial reports to ECOSOC and DPI will be prepared by the Representatives. Copies of the reports are to be forwarded to the Connectional President for signature. The representatives shall be responsible for maintaining public relations with other non-governmental organizations and affiliated agencies of the United Nations. Information shall be distributed to the Episcopal Districts through the Supervisor, Episcopal President, First Vice President and NGO District Liaison.

- Section 7. **Episcopal District NGO Liaisons.** Episcopal District NGO Liaisons shall be appointed by the Supervisor of each District. The Liaison shall be responsible for the dissemination of NGO information and spearhead NGO programming within their District to Local, Area, and Conference societies. Regular reports shall be prepared on all NGO related activities and programming in the District and shall be distributed to the Supervisor, Episcopal President, Connectional NGO Representatives and others as determined by the Supervisor.
- Section 8. **Annual NGO Conference.** An Annual NGO Conference will be held at the United Nations and/or surrounding area at which the written NGO reports from the Districts will be presented. The District reports shall also be used to compile the Annual and Quadrennial Reports to the Women's Missionary Society. The Conference is open to all Women's Missionary Society members.
- Section 9. **Funds.** Any funds collected specifically for NGO projects and programming shall be kept as designated funds, project specific by the Treasurer of the Women's Missionary Society, reported as same, and held for distribution at the determination of the President.
- Section 10. **Office Maintenance.** Non-Governmental Organization activities and general expenses as well as the maintenance of an office in New York at the United Nations Church Center shall be included in the Women's Missionary Society Budget.

Article III - Membership

- Section 1. **Regular.** Membership in this organization shall be comprised of all women of the church, upon payment of local dues, where applicable, except women who are **Ordained Clergy**, in good and regular standing in their Local organization. (Refer to the Glossary of *The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church* under the heading "good and regular standing.")
- Section 2. **Associate.** Any male in good and regular standing in the Local church may become an Associate member upon payment of dues. An Associate member is ineligible to vote except spouses of Bishops who are actively serving as Supervisors of Episcopal Districts. No male shall hold office in the Organization.
- Section 3. **Life.** Life membership shall be governed by the provisions in Article VIII herein. Life members are part of the voting delegation and shall receive sustentation.

Article IV - Quadrennial Convention; Delegates; Special Convention

- Section 1. **Quadrennial Convention.** In addition to its powers and duties as provided in the constitution of the organization, the Quadrennial Convention shall:
- Elect the officers as provided in the constitution and bylaws;
 - Review the work of Connectional officers and commissions and for this purpose require and receive reports from them;
 - Fulfill other functions as required by this constitution and bylaws;
 - Conduct such other business as necessary to further the mission, purpose and functions of the organization; and
 - Have the sole authority to amend the constitution and bylaws.

Section 2. **Convention Delegates.** By plurality vote, there shall be five (5) elected delegates from a Conference with a voting membership of three hundred fifty (350) or more; four (4) elected delegates from a Conference with a voting membership of two hundred fifty (250) to three hundred forty-nine (349); three (3) elected delegates from a Conference with a voting membership of one hundred fifty (150) to two hundred forty-nine (249); and two (2) elected delegates from a Conference with a voting membership of seventy-five (75) to one hundred forty-nine (149); and one (1) elected delegate from a Conference with a voting membership of less than seventy-five (75). Each Conference shall have at least one (1) elected delegate.

Alternates to the Quadrennial Convention shall be elected at the same time as the delegates. The number of alternates that a Conference may elect can be up to or equal to the number of delegates elected. The Conference President and Commission on Administration shall decide how many alternates will be elected. Each Conference must have at least one alternate. Alternates shall serve in the absence of delegates.

Section 3. **Submission of Delegates.** The Episcopal Supervisor shall submit to the Connectional President at least six (6) months before the Quadrennial Convention a certified listing of the total voting membership in the Quadrennial Convention, which listing will include the elected delegates and alternates from the conferences, the life members, Episcopal Presidents, past and present Episcopal Supervisors, Episcopal District YPD Directors, and the voting Connectional Officers from the District, Conference Presidents and Conference YPD Directors. Delegates elected to serve at the Quadrennial Convention shall continue to serve until delegates are elected for the next regular Quadrennial Convention, provided they have not ceased to be a member of the Conference from which they were elected or have not been superseded by the election of new delegates.

Section 4. **Expenses of Delegates.** The organization will be responsible for the reasonable travel costs and sustenance of the Episcopal Supervisors, Episcopal Presidents, Episcopal Directors, and Episcopal Presidents of the Young People's and Children's Division from the Fourteenth, Fifteenth, Sixteenth, Seventeenth, Eighteenth, Nineteenth and Twentieth Episcopal Districts.

For the First through Thirteenth Episcopal Districts, the organization will be responsible for the sustenance of the delegates, provided each Episcopal District has paid its yearly assessments during the Quadrennium.

Section 5. **Committees of the Quadrennial Convention.** Committees of the Quadrennial Convention shall be the Rules Committee, Credentials Committee, Memorial Committee, Program Committee, Constitution and Bylaws Committee, Nominating Committee, and Election Committee. Members of these committees shall be appointed by the President:

- a. *Rules Committee.* This committee shall review the rules of the previous Quadrennial Convention and prepare proposed rules for the governance of the present Quadrennial Convention. On the opening day, the committee shall present such rules to the delegates of the Quadrennial Convention.
- b. *Credentials Committee.* This committee shall rule on matters of challenge to any elected delegate or Life Member from any Episcopal District.
- c. *Tanner Turner Memorial Committee.* This committee shall plan a creative Memorial Service for deceased members of the organization.

- d. *Constitution and Bylaws Committee.* The Compilation and Revisions Committee, consisting of three (3) persons, shall prepare a printed legislative package to be given to each voting member of the Quadrennial Convention immediately following the organization of the Quadrennial Convention. This committee shall also collect, assemble and correct any scrivener's errors, duplications or contradictions in adopted legislation of the Quadrennial Convention and present the same.
- e. *Nominating Committee.* This committee shall be governed by the provisions of Article VII, Section 3 herein.
- f. *Program Committee.* This committee shall be responsible for the planning, budgeting and coordinating of the Quadrennial Convention, in conjunction with the president.
- g. *Election Committee.* This committee shall be governed by the provisions of Article VII, Section 2 herein.

Section 6. **Special Quadrennial Convention.** If a Special Quadrennial Convention is called, delegates in the preceding Quadrennial Convention shall be given written notice of the convention, as well as other voting members as provided in Article VI of the constitution, provided they have not ceased to be a member of the Conference from which they were elected or have not been superseded by election of new delegates.

Section 7. **Registered Observers.** Registered observers may attend the convention at no additional expense to the organization. They may participate in the programs and attend the sessions of the convention. They shall have no voice and no vote.

Article V - Executive Board

Section 1. **Composition; Quorum.** The Executive Board shall be comprised of the elected Connectional officers, past and present Episcopal Supervisors, past Connectional WMS Presidents, Episcopal WMS Presidents, the Connectional YPD Director, Connectional YPD President and Episcopal Directors of the Young People's and Children's Division. The Commission Chair of Global Witness and Ministry and the Bishops shall be ex-officio members. Each Episcopal District shall be represented on the Executive Board. A majority of the members of the Executive Board shall constitute a quorum to transact business and make decisions.

Section 2. **Purpose; Duties.** In accordance with the constitution, the Executive Board shall act during the interim of the Quadrennial Convention. The duties of the Executive Board shall be to:

- a. Receive and act upon the recommendations of the president;
- b. Approve or disapprove the actions of the Commission on Administration;
- c. Determine the time of the election of officers;
- d. Act on such matters as delegated to it by the Quadrennial Convention;
- e. Approve the assessments of the Episcopal Districts and an annual budget for the organization, upon recommendation from the Commission on Administration;
- f. Transact the necessary business and make programmatic decisions between Quadrennial Conventions;
- g. Determine the incapacity of an elected officer to perform her duties, or the non-performance of duties by an elected officer, and determine if she shall be removed from office. For the removal of an elected officer for incapacity or non-performance, a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Executive Board shall be required;

- h. Fill vacancies in elected offices until the next Quadrennial Convention, as provided in Article VI, Section 7 herein; and
- i. Act in accord with the actions of, and policies established by, the Quadrennial Convention and the constitution and bylaws of the organization.

Section 3. **Meetings; Expenses.** The Executive Board shall meet annually, except in the year of the Quadrennial Convention. The Connectional organization shall be responsible for the expenses, reasonable costs for travel and housing, for elected Connectional officers.

Section 4. **Special Meetings.** Special meetings of the Executive Board may be called by the president or, in the event of the president's death, resignation or incapacity, by the Commission on Administration. The notice of the special meeting shall state the purpose of the meeting.

Article VI - Elected Officers

Section 1. **Election of Officers.** Officers shall be elected at the Quadrennial Convention, unless otherwise provided for herein. All elections shall be by electronic or paper ballot, except when there is only one (1) candidate for an office. When there is only one (1) candidate for an office, voting may be by voice or hand vote. A majority vote shall be necessary to elect. Elected officers shall assume office immediately upon installation.

Section 2. **Elected Officers.** The elected officers shall be the President, First Vice President, Second Vice President, Third Vice President, Recording Secretary, Assistant Recording Secretary, Corresponding Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Historiographer-Statistician, Editor of the Magazine, Associate Editor, Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, Parliamentarian, Worship Director and Member-At-Large.

Section 3. **Prerequisites for Holding Office.** Any person seeking an elected office must:

- a. Be a member in good and regular standing in the organization; "good and regular standing" in this organization means that the member regularly attends the meetings of the organization, is supportive of mission projects of the organization, participates in its activities and events, is current in payment of dues and other financial obligations;
- b. Demonstrate a Christian commitment;
- c. Demonstrate a high level of spiritual maturity;
- d. Possess good interpersonal and communication skills;
- e. Demonstrate a collaborative work style;
- f. Be sensitive to the tradition and culture of the A.M.E. Church; and
- g. Possess the qualifications required for the office as provided in Article IX of these bylaws.

Section 4. **Term; Limitation.** The term of elected officers shall be four (4) years. Elected officers may serve a maximum of two consecutive four (4) year terms or eight (8) consecutive years in the same office. Upon completion of an eight (8) year term, an officer shall be eligible to serve in other elected Connectional offices or appointed positions for a maximum of eight (8) consecutive years.

This provision shall operate for persons appointed to positions by the Connectional President.

A person's total years of service as an elected officer or appointed person, regardless of the number of elected or appointed positions held by the person, shall not exceed sixteen (16) years.

Section 5. **Transitional Period.** A transitional period of six (6) weeks upon the close of a Quadrennial Convention is hereby provided for outgoing officers to make inventories, reconcile files and records before turning them over to the incoming officers. Outgoing officers shall transfer all records, books, papers and property belonging to the organization to incoming officers on or before the end of the six (6) weeks.

Section 6. **Vacancy in Office of the President.** In the event of a vacancy in the office of President due to death, resignation, disability or temporary inability or other cause, the First Vice President shall immediately assume the office of President, until an election of a new President can be held or until the President is able to serve again. The new president shall be elected at the next Quadrennial Convention. Any person elected to fill an unexpired term of president shall subsequently be eligible to be elected to two (2) full four (4) year terms in accordance with this constitution and bylaws.

Section 7. **Vacancy in Elected Offices Other Than President.** In the event of a vacancy in an elected officer's position, other than the president, due to the death, resignation, disability or inability to serve, the President shall appoint an active member in good standing to fill the vacancy if the remainder of the term of office is less than two (2) years. The appointment shall be confirmed by the Executive Board at its next regularly scheduled meeting, said determination resulting by a majority vote of that body. If the remainder of the term of office is greater than two (2) years, a special election shall be held by the Executive Board within forty-five (45) days to fill the position. Any person appointed to fill an unexpired term shall subsequently be eligible to be elected to two full four (4) year terms in accordance with the provisions of this constitution and bylaws.

Section 8. **Removal of Elected Officers.** Any elected officer, not performing her duties shall be notified in writing by the president, with a copy to the Chairman of the Commission on Global Witness and Ministry and the Executive Board. If such failure to perform continues for a period of ninety (90) days after notification, the matter shall be referred to the Executive Board for action. The Executive Board may remove the elected officer from office for failure to execute her duties and responsibilities as provided in these constitution and bylaws.

Section 9. **Salary of President.** The President of the Women's Missionary Society shall receive a salary and benefits as provided to General Officers of the A.M.E. Church. The salary and benefits of the president shall be paid by the organization.

Article VII - Nominations and Election Process

Section 1. **Procedures.** The organization shall elect such officers as required by the constitution and bylaws.

Section 2. **General Requirements and Considerations.**

a. Each nominee for an elected position in this organization shall be a member of the

- organization and shall possess the qualifications required for the position being sought.
- b. At least 10% of the nominees shall be persons who are members of Districts 14-20. Members from Districts 14-20 shall be encouraged to run for all positions.
 - c. No elected officer **or appointed person** shall hold two (2) positions of leadership simultaneously in the Connectional, Episcopal or Conference organizations. An elected officer **or appointed person** may hold an elected office in a Local organization.
 - d. The terms of office of persons elected shall begin at the conclusion of the Quadrennial Convention at which such persons were elected.
 - e. There shall be no nominations from the floor of a Quadrennial Convention.
 - f. All elections shall be by electronic or paper ballot, except when there is only one candidate for an office. When there is only one candidate for an office, voting may be by voice or hand vote.
 - g. A majority of votes cast on the first ballot shall be necessary for the election of an officer. If an election does not occur on the first ballot, the names of the two (2) persons receiving the highest number of votes cast shall be placed on the second ballot. On the second ballot, a majority of the votes cast shall be necessary for election.
 - h. Members of the Nominating Committee shall be ineligible for nomination by the committee to any position to be filled.

Section 3. **The Nominating Committee.**

- a. *Committee appointments.* The Nominating Committee shall consist of nine (9) persons appointed by the president. The president in selecting committee members shall follow these guidelines:
 - a. No more than one person shall be appointed from an Episcopal District; and
 - b. Consideration shall be given to geographic location, variety of ages, and diversity of experiences.
- b. *Duties of the Committee.* The committee shall:
 - 1. At least nine (9) months prior to the Quadrennial Convention, call for nominations through a notice published in an official periodical of the Women's Missionary Society (and any other appropriate publication). Such notice shall also indicate how a nomination form may be obtained. Nomination forms shall be sent to Executive Board members and Episcopal Supervisors for distribution to interested persons. The nomination form shall request individuals to give biographical data and other information, which will aid in the selection of candidates. Such credential forms shall be returned by prospective nominees bearing the signature of the Episcopal President and Supervisor, no later than 180 days prior to the Quadrennial Convention; and
 - 2. Give considerations to the names submitted or recommended as nominees for offices, examining any and all necessary information regarding the persons to determine if the persons meet the prerequisites and qualifications for the offices being sought. For those persons found to meet the prerequisites and qualifications of the office being sought, the committee shall prepare a slate of nominees, listing the qualifications of the nominees for office to be elected at the Quadrennial Convention. The slate shall be provided to each Episcopal Nominating Committee Chairperson no later than ninety (90) days before the Quadrennial Convention.

Article VIII - Life Memberships

Section 1. **Life Member.** After twenty-five (25) years of continuous meritorious service in the Women's Missionary Society, a member is eligible to apply for Life Membership. An applicant for Life Membership shall

- a. Be actively serving in the Local, Area (if applicable) Conference and Episcopal organizations at the time of submitting the application;
- b. Exemplify continuous meritorious service;
- c. Be recommended by the Local Women's Missionary Society and approved by the Conference; and
- d. Remain active at these levels of service as long as life and health permits.

Section 2. **Continuous Meritorious Service.**

- a. Meritorious service may be defined as continuous significant contributions through demonstrated leadership at the Local, Conference, Episcopal, and/or Connectional levels.
- b. Continuous meritorious service may include, yet not be limited to:
 1. Demonstrated continuous service at the Local level;
 2. Distinguished services as an officer (elected or appointed) at one or more levels (Conference, Episcopal, Connectional);
 3. Recruited and encouraged new members;
 4. Developed or initiated programs to promote missionary education; and
 5. Directed or chaired significant missionary programs at one or more levels of the Women's Missionary Society, etc.

Section 3. **General Information.**

- a. There shall be one Life Member per Conference in an Episcopal District per Quadrennium. Only deceased Life Members are to be replaced during a Quadrennium. A copy of the Obituary or Homegoing Service shall accompany the candidate's application for Life Membership.
- b. Annually, all applications for Life Membership shall be kept on the Conference roll and reported in the order submitted via postmarked date of the local church recommendation. This list remains current as the new names are added to it.
- c. A Life Member who transfers from one Conference to another Conference or from one District to another District shall be entitled to all rights and privileges afforded her during her previous affiliation, upon receipt of a "Letter of Transfer" from the sending Conference or District bearing the signatures of the Local President & Local Pastor, the Conference President, the Episcopal President, and the Episcopal Supervisor. The receiving Conference President or District president shall sign the "Letter of Transfer" and send it to the Episcopal Supervisor who will submit it to the Connectional President. A form letter should be provided by the Connectional WMS Office for this purpose.

Section 4. **The Process.**

The member must be recommended by certified letter from the Local society, after twenty-five (25) years of meritorious service in the Women's Missionary Society. The recommendation should be sent to the Episcopal Supervisor and copied to the Episcopal President, Episcopal Third Vice President and Conference President.

The following steps should be adhered to:

- a. At the start of a new Quadrennium, the Conference President notifies the next Life Member applicant, as determined by the process outlined in Section 3b above, that she is eligible for the Quadrennial Life Membership. The Life Member application shall be secured from the Headquarters Office of the Women's Missionary Society upon the request of the Conference President and the Episcopal Supervisor.
- b. Once completed by the Life Member applicant, a fee of Two Hundred Fifty dollars (\$250.00) for Districts 1-13 and One Hundred dollars (\$100.00) for Districts 14-20 shall be attached to the application.
- c. The application shall be signed by the Local President, the Pastor, the Conference President, the Episcopal President, the Episcopal Supervisor, and the Bishop and the application is sent to the Connectional President with the fee attached.

Section 5. **Memorial Ceremony.** A ceremony to pay tribute to a Life Member may be conducted at the Wake or prior to the Funeral Service of the deceased member.

Section 6. **Connectional Life Member Stole.** The stole is to be worn with white attire. It may be worn at official occasions and special worship services on all levels.

Section 7. **Recognition.** Upon becoming a Life Member, the person shall receive the following:

- a. A Life Membership card;
- b. A Life Membership pin; and
- c. A Life Membership stole.

Section 8. **Use of Application Funds.** Funds received for Life Memberships shall be used for the printing and production costs associated with the Life Membership cards, pins and stoles, the Hughes-Smith Life Membership Booklet, as well as other Connectional contingencies.

Section 9. **Other.** The Commission on Membership and Recruitment shall create and publish a Life Membership booklet, after review and input from the Connectional President and Commission on Administration, which booklet shall contain the following: suggested Life Membership ceremony(ies); suggested activities for each level of the organization; information on the Connectional Women's Endowment Fund, legacy bequests and gifts; and an annual report form for the Local, Conference, Episcopal organizations.

Article IX - Duties and Qualifications of Officers

Section 1. **President.**

- a. ***Qualifications.*** Any candidate seeking the position of President must have:
 1. At least a Bachelor's degree from an accredited institution or the equivalent in education and experience. A Master's or higher degree is preferred;
 2. Demonstrated prior service as an elected officer of the Connectional, Episcopal or Conference organization;
 3. At least five (5) years of administrative, supervisory or managerial experience; and
 4. An inspiring, encouraging and unifying leadership style.
- b. ***Duties and Responsibilities.*** The duties and responsibilities of the President shall be to:
 1. Preside at the Quadrennial Convention, Executive Board, the Commission on Administration and other official meetings of the organization;

2. Have general supervision and direction over the work and activities of the organization;
3. Appoint members to all Commissions and committees for which election or appointment procedures are not provided and make other appointments as necessary. In making appointments to the commissions, the President shall appoint young women ages 40 years and younger to at least 10% of the available positions on each commission and shall stagger the appointment of persons to the commissions from two (2) to four (4) years;
4. Chair the Commission on Administration and serve as an ex-officio member of all commissions and committees as may be necessary to the conduct and development of the organization;
5. Work with the Commission on Administration, actively seeking to advance all phases of the work of the organization;
6. Propose policy for review and action by the Commission on Administration and provide for the implementation, within such policies, of the financial, accounting, insurance, property management, investment and money management systems and related services for the organization;
7. Submit a report to each Quadrennial Convention and Executive Board concerning her work, with observations and recommendations affecting the organization as she may deem important;
8. Represent the organization at ecumenical associations, councils and organizations in which the organization participates;
9. Serve as a member of the General Conference by virtue of her office;
10. Ensure that the constitution and bylaws are duly observed and that the actions thereof are carried into effect; and
11. Sign all official and legal papers and vouchers or orders on the treasury.

Section 2. **First Vice President.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the position of First Vice President must possess the same qualifications as provided for the President.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The First Vice President shall:
 1. Serve in the absence, disability or resignation of the President;
 2. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration;
 3. Serve as Coordinator of the Commission on Christian Social Action and its liaison to the Commission on Administration; and
 4. Facilitate the Commission on Christian Social Action's interaction and work with the Episcopal, Conference and Local Commissions on Christian Social Action.

Section 3. **Second Vice President.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the office of Second Vice President must possess the same qualifications as the President.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Second Vice President shall:
 1. Serve in the absence, disability or resignation of the President and First Vice President;
 2. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration;
 3. Serve as Coordinator of the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation and its liaison to the Commission on Administration; and
 4. Facilitate interaction and work with the Episcopal, Conference and Local Commissions on Mission Education and Interpretation.

Section 4. **Third Vice President**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate for the position of Third Vice President must possess the same qualifications as the President.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Third Vice President shall:
 1. Serve in the absence, disability or resignation of the President and First and Second Vice Presidents;
 2. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration;
 3. Serve as Coordinator of the Commission on Membership and Recruitment and its liaison to the Commission on Administration and keep the Commission on Administration informed about the needs and concerns of members and recommended plans for membership cultivation;
 4. Coordinate the work of the Connectional membership and recruitment activities; and
 5. Facilitate the interaction and work with the Episcopal, Conference and Local Commissions on Membership and Recruitment to determine the needs of the membership, to enlist new members, and to recommend ways for inactive members to participate.

Section 5. **Recording Secretary**

- a. *Qualifications.* A candidate seeking the office of Recording Secretary must demonstrate:
 1. Experience and skills in word processing, computer technology or other technology available for recording or retrieving information;
 2. Prior secretarial experience or training; and
 3. An ability to prepare and present minutes and reports.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Recording Secretary shall:
 1. Be the secretary of the Quadrennial Convention, Executive Board and Commission on Administration;
 2. Be responsible for recording, keeping and distributing accurate minutes of the Quadrennial Convention, Executive Board and Commission on Administration. Keep an accurate record of all proceedings in a bound book, and under the direction of the President, perform all other duties common to such office;
 3. Make available copies for the delegates of each day's session of the Quadrennial Convention;
 4. Make available copies of minutes of the Quadrennial Convention within ninety (90) days of the close of the Quadrennial Convention;
 5. Maintain a Record Book in which the current constitution and bylaws, special rules of order, minutes are entered with any amendments to these documents properly recorded, and have the current Record Books on hand at every official meeting;
 6. Make available to officers copies of the minutes of all official meetings including the Executive Board within six (6) weeks of the date held;
 7. Keep an official roll of the Executive Board; and
 8. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration.

Section 6. **Assistant Recording Secretary**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate for the position of Assistant Recording Secretary must possess the same qualifications as the Recording Secretary.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Assistant Recording Secretary shall:
 1. Assist the Recording Secretary in keeping all records;
 2. At the absence of the Secretary shall perform her duties; and

3. Serve as a member of the Commission of Administration.

Section 7. **Corresponding Secretary.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate for the position of Corresponding Secretary must possess the same qualifications as the Recording Secretary.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Corresponding Secretary shall:
 1. Assist the Recording Secretary in preparing the minutes for official meetings of the Connectional Society;
 2. Prepare and send correspondence under the direction of the President;
 3. Perform such other secretarial duties as determined by the President; and
 4. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration and the Commission on Membership and Recruitment.

Section 8: **Treasurer.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate for the position of Treasurer must have:
 1. At least a Bachelor's degree, or its equivalent, in business, accounting or finance; and
 2. At least five (5) years of experience in accounting, finance, or budgeting.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Treasurer shall:
 1. Provide for financial record keeping and, on behalf of the Executive Board, be accountable for all funds of the organization in accordance with the financial policies of the organization;
 2. Prepare an annual Executive Board and Quadrennial Convention budget for the approval of the Commission on Administration, in consultation with the President.
 3. Upon the request of the President, write and sign all checks, which shall be countersigned by the President;
 4. Interpret the financial condition of the organization for the Commission on Administration and the Executive Board;
 5. Be bonded in an amount as required by the Commission on Administration;
 6. Have the accounts audited by a Certified Public Accountant with a report submitted to the Quadrennial Convention during the first business session, and an interim report to the Executive Board and General Board of the A.M.E. Church; and
 7. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration.

Section 9. **Financial Secretary**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate for the position of Financial Secretary must have:
 1. At least a Bachelor's Degree, or its equivalent, in business, accounting or finance; and
 2. At least five (5) years of experience in accounting, finance or budgeting.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Financial Secretary shall:
 1. Maintain an independent set of records of all financial transactions;
 2. Assist with the work in concert with the Treasurer; and
 3. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration.

Section 10. **Director of the Young People's and Children's Division.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the office of Director of the Young People's and Children's Division must have:
 1. At least a Bachelor's Degree or the equivalent in education and experience. A Master's or higher degree is preferred;

2. Prior service as a Director of an Episcopal, a Conference (including Area) or a Local Young People's and Children's Division;
 3. Demonstrated, successful experiences working with and organizing young people, young adults and children;
 4. The ability to recognize, appreciate and channel energy and creativity of young people, young adults and children; and
 5. Prior administrative, supervisory or managerial experience with young people or children.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Director of the Young People's and Children's Division shall:
1. Plan and direct a mission program for the young people within the framework of the purpose of the organization;
 2. Perform such duties as provided for the Director in the Bylaws of the Connectional Young People's and Children's Division; and
 3. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration.

Section 11. **Editor of the Missionary Magazine.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the position of Editor of the Women's Missionary Society Magazine must have:
1. At least a Bachelor's degree or the equivalent in education and experience. A Master's or higher degree is preferred;
 2. Extensive course work in English, Speech or Journalism;
 3. An understanding of the publication process; and
 4. At least five (5) years' experience in journalism; or in editing, developing and publishing educational materials.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Editor of the Women's Missionary Society Magazine duties and responsibilities shall be to:
1. Oversee the production of the official magazine of the organization, editing and publishing a bi-monthly periodical containing news of general interest to church women and news regarding the organization, including news from all senior officers, commissions or committees and the Young People's and Children's Division;
 2. Solicit and edit articles for the publication on topics that will appeal to, inspire and motivate subscribers;
 3. Oversee the entire publication process, including seeking bids from publishers;
 4. Provide for promotion, circulation, subscription fulfillment, advertising solicitation, billing and collection of accounts, and other services, providing reports and records of such activities to the Commission on Administration;
 5. In collaboration with the Treasurer, prepare a yearly budget for the magazine's publication, monitor and report on the financial component of the Editor's office, for submission to the President and Commission on Administration;
 6. Through the Commission on Administration develop any editorial and advertising guidelines as needed; and
 7. Serve as the organization's representative to organizations which enhance the work of the Editor.
 8. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration and the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation which is responsible for the educational enterprise of the organization.

Section 12. **Associate Editor.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the position of Associate Editor shall possess the same qualifications as the Editor.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Associate Editor of the Missionary Magazine shall:
 1. Work in cooperation with the Editor in the editing and publishing of the Magazine;
 2. Assume the responsibilities of helping to promote and increase subscriptions to the Magazine; and
 3. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration and the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.

Section 13. **Promotion and Missionary Education Director.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the position of Promotion and Missionary Education Director must have:
 1. At least a Bachelor's Degree or the equivalent in education and experience. A Master's or higher degree is preferred;
 2. Extensive course work in research and writing, English, Speech or Journalism; and
 3. At least five (5) years' experience in journalism, editing, developing and publishing educational and research materials.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Promotion and Missionary Education Director duties and responsibilities shall be:
 1. Developing, producing, promoting and circulating mission education materials, including but not limited to, compiling, editing, design work and meeting publication time periods; preparing and mailing introductory kits to Episcopal Directors of Promotion and Missionary Education and various other complimentary mailings; transmitting orders to the publisher; providing supplementary materials to members; and providing invoices and monitoring final payments;
 2. Recommending themes and curricula to the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation for approval;
 3. Seeking talent from across the twenty Episcopal Districts of the organization to contribute to the mission education effort;
 4. Convening the Mission Education and Interpretation Dialogue annually;
 5. Developing continuing education programs for the organization's leaders;
 6. Assisting in the planning and developing of the Connectional training efforts for the Executive Board and Quadrennial Convention;
 7. Providing leadership in developing audio-visual and other resources to complement the Study Guide;
 8. Developing and overseeing a correspondence course or on-line education or training module;
 9. Compiling current bibliographies of books, tracts, etc., relating to religious education;
 10. Developing and overseeing the Connectional Book Club, and providing an on-line dialogue on current readings;
 11. In collaboration with the Treasurer, prepare a yearly budget for submission to the President and Commission on Administration, monitor and report on the financial aspects of her work; and
 12. Other duties as determined by the President or the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation; and

13. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration and the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.

Section 14. **Historiographer-Statistician.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the position of Historiographer-Statistician must have:
 1. At least a Bachelor's Degree or the equivalent in education and experience;
 2. Demonstrated prior experience in research, writing and publishing;
 3. Extensive course work in English;
 4. An ability to use technology for data gathering, organizing, record keeping and writing; and
 5. Demonstrated good sense of history and an appreciation for the need to maintain records.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Historiographer-Statistician shall:
 1. Have full responsibility of assembling, gathering and maintaining the data pertaining to the history of the organization; including, but not limited to requesting all facts and figures relating to the Local, Conference and Episcopal membership, officers and mission work and activities;
 2. Compile a written Quadrennial history of the Women's Missionary Society and shall submit it as a report to the Quadrennial Convention; and
 3. Compile accurate and adequate data and information and publish the same under the direction of the President and the Executive Board. This information shall be centered in the office of the Women's Missionary Society for reference when needed; and
 4. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration and the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.

Section 15. **Worship Director.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the position of Worship Director must have:
 1. Training and experience in Christian Education;
 2. Knowledge of the Bible and Hymnal;
 3. Training and/or knowledge of Worship, Liturgy and music;
 4. Experience in preparing and conducting Bible study and worship;
 5. Demonstrated capacity to work effectively with others.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Worship Director shall:
 1. Serve the organization by providing appropriate and creative styles and types of worship experiences/devotions.
 2. Maintain effective communication with the Episcopal District and Conference Worship Directors; and
 3. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration and the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.

Section 16. **Member-At-Large.**

- a. *Qualifications.* Any candidate seeking the position of Member-At-Large must:
 1. Must be ages eighteen (18) to forty (40); and
 2. Have at least a Bachelor's degree or its equivalent in education or experience.
- b. *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Member-At-Large shall:
 1. Work with the Young Adult Members, ages eighteen (18) to forty (40), to facilitate the goals and objectives of the Commission on Membership and Recruitment relative to

- younger women; and
- 2. Be responsible for promoting the Sojourner's Program and in cooperation with church leaders and Episcopal Districts recruit volunteers.
- 3. Serve as a member of the Commission on Administration and the Commission on Membership and Recruitment.

Section 17. **Parliamentarian.** Any candidate seeking the position of Parliamentarian shall be certified in parliamentary procedures, at the time of her nomination. The Parliamentarian shall serve as a member of the Commission on Administration. Should nominations not be received from a person(s) certified in parliamentary procedures, the President, through the Commission on Administration, may contract for such services to be provided to the organization as needed

Article X - Episcopal Supervisors

Section 1. **Designation.** The Episcopal Supervisor shall be the spouse or the appointee of the Bishop of the Episcopal District.

Section 2. **Duties.** The Episcopal Supervisor shall:

- a. Have supervision of the work in the Episcopal District; Be the liaison between the Connectional and Episcopal organizations, and work cooperatively with the Connectional WMS to carry out the programmatic functions and responsibilities throughout the Episcopal District;
- b. Ensure the constitution and bylaws are duly observed and the actions thereof are carried into effect;
- c. Provide oversight for the fiscal and program operations of the Episcopal District;
- d. Facilitate and provide opportunities for the Episcopal, Conference and Local organizations' financial support of the organization;
- e. Prepare and submit a report to each Quadrennial Convention concerning the work of the Episcopal District;
- f. With the Episcopal President, plan and implement a comprehensive program that fosters cooperative and interdependent relationships among the Local, Conference, Episcopal and Connectional organizations, to implement the mission and purpose of the organization;
- g. With the Episcopal President, promote and facilitate the programs, goals and objectives of the organization; and
- h. Serve on the Executive Board and on at least one (1) of the Commissions.

Article XI - Commissions

Section 1. **Responsibilities Common to Commissions.** Each commission shall:

- a. Recommend policy, envision and develop strategic plans in its particular area of responsibility, after consultation with the commissions of the Episcopal, Conference and Local, as practicable as possible. All policies shall be submitted to the Commission on Administration for further consideration and action;
- b. Develop and implement programs and resources, and review and evaluate processes, to enable and assist members in facilitating and fulfilling the work of the Commission;
- c. Facilitate and coordinate with other Commissions of the organization, this organization's efforts in leadership development and leadership training;
- d. Develop and disseminate to members materials of significance for the work of the

- Commissions;
- e. Provide for the adequate keepings of records related to the activities and work of the Commission; and
- f. Cultivate a community of collaboration and outreach with other Connectional, Episcopal, Conference and Local Commissions.

Section 2. **Responsibilities Common to Commission Chair or Coordinator.** The Commission Chair or Coordinator shall:

- a. Provide leadership and facilitate the work of the Commission;
- b. Preside at meetings of the Commission;
- c. Serve as the liaison to the Commission on Administration and Executive Board;
- d. Monitor the progress of the Commission and provide reports to the President as needed; and
- e. Facilitate the setting of goals by the Commission, and a plan for the evaluation of the work and activities of the Commission.

Section 3. **Commission on Administration.**

- a. *Creation; Duties.* There is hereby created a Commission on Administration. The Commission shall be chaired by the President and shall:
 - 1. Be responsible for the business of the organization, including budget and finance decisions concerning the implementation of policy;
 - 2. Ensure that resolutions from the Quadrennial Convention and recommendations and policies from Executive Board are appropriately managed;
 - 3. Upon the advice and recommendations of the President, establish the assessments for Episcopal Districts for the Quadrennial and the time for paying such assessments each fiscal year. Any changes in such assessments between the Quadrennial Conventions shall be presented to the Executive Board for approval;
 - 4. Maintain and distribute accurate records;
 - 5. Receive reports and monitor progress of the Commissions on Christian Social Action, Mission Education and Interpretation and Membership and Recruitment;
 - 6. Develop and recommend an annual budget to Executive Board;
 - 7. Review and modify, when necessary, financial policies of the organization;
 - 8. Provide for a comprehensive financial support system for the administration of financial resources necessary for fulfillment of the responsibilities of the Connectional organization;
 - 9. Review, analyze and be prepared to interpret the annual audit;
 - 10. Develop appropriate investment strategies for the organization;
 - 11. Oversee quadrennial review and revision of the organization's constitution and bylaws;
 - 12. Oversee the work of the Nominating Committee;
 - 13. Engage a licensed Parliamentarian, when necessary;
 - 14. Design programs and other activities providing for an improved image of the organization;
 - 15. Design and conduct training;
 - 16. Oversee the work of the Sojourner Global Program as outlined in Article XI of the Constitution; and
 - 17. Maintain an office and a continuing relationship with the Economic and Social Council of the United Nations through such representatives as appointed by the President.
- b. *Commission Members.* The members of the Commission on Administration shall consist

of: the President, the First, Second and Third Vice Presidents, the Recording Secretary, the Assistant Recording Secretary, the Corresponding Secretary, the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary, the Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, the Editor of the Magazine, the Associate Editor, the Promotion and Missionary Education Director, the Historiographer- Statistician, the Worship Director, the Member-At-Large, the Parliamentarian, seven (7) Episcopal Supervisors, present or past, and four (4) At-Large-Members with expertise and skills in accounting, financial management, law, and administration appointed by the President.

Section 4. **Commission on Christian Social Action.**

- a. *Creation; Duties.* There is hereby created a Commission on Christian Social Action. The First Vice President shall serve as the coordinator of the commission whose duties and responsibilities shall be to:
 1. Promote social action, which will engage women in addressing current critical issues; Identify and study issues affecting the family and develop appropriate educational programs and strategies to address these issues;
 2. Identify and plan educational activities to help families understand their responsibilities;
 3. Distribute pertinent information on global health and wellness;
 4. Partner with community agencies and organizations involved in eradicating poverty and hunger;
 5. Provide tangible help for persons in dire need;
 6. Provide opportunities for members of the organization to understand and work with organizations such as, Church Women United, Bread for the World, National Council of Negro Women, Black Women's Agenda, Religious Network for the Equality of Women, Children's Defense Fund, and the Balm in Gilead;
 7. Review and monitor the Missionaries on the Move Project and other volunteer mission programs of the organization; and
 8. Encourage and support current national programs such as, Church World Service Blanket, Tools of Hope Program, and Crop Walks.
- b. *Commission Members.* The members of the Commission on Christian Social Action shall be the First Vice President, two (2) Episcopal Presidents, three (3) Episcopal First Vice Presidents, two (2) Conference Presidents, three (3) Local Presidents, seven (7) Episcopal Supervisors, and four (4) At-Large-Members, each appointed by the President to represent issues and interests of ecumenical relations, family life, global health and housing, rural and special missions.

Section 5. **Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.**

- a. *Creation; Duties.* There is hereby created a Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation. The Second Vice President shall serve as the coordinator of the Commission whose duties and responsibilities shall be:
 1. Developing a strong faith base and develop members for ministry by planning and conducting annual institutes and other activities;
 2. Design, produce, print and circulate the Connectional organization's mission study program;
 3. Plan and conduct educational activities designed to create an awareness of the status of Black women and their contributions individually and collectively to life and society;
 4. Establish a central unit for researching, collecting, classifying, analyzing, interpreting

- and disseminating information about the progress and plight of Black people;
 - 5. Seek funding for educational pursuits of the organization;
 - 6. Improve Public Relations techniques and efforts and strengthen media coverage;
 - 7. Discover and develop ability of persons in the performing and creative arts;
 - 8. Promote the use of creative arts for enrichment and well-being;
 - 9. Sponsor an exhibit of art at the Quadrennial Convention;
 - 10. Raise visibility and awareness of the organization;
 - 11. Supervise the educational thrust of the organization; and
 - 12. Encourage and support bible studies and worship experiences at all gatherings.
- b. *Commission Members.* The members of the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation shall be the following: the Second Vice President, the Historiographer-Statistician, the Editor of the Magazine, the Associate Editor, the Promotion and Missionary Education Director, the Worship Director, seven (7) Episcopal Supervisors and twenty (20) At-Large-Members. The twenty At-Large-Members shall consist of a representative from each of the twenty Episcopal Districts, and shall be appointed by the President, with at least three (3) of the At-Large-Members being Episcopal Second Vice Presidents.

Section 6. **Commission on Membership and Recruitment.**

- a. *Qualifications.* There is hereby created a Commission on Membership and Recruitment. The Third Vice President shall be the coordinator of the commission whose duties and responsibilities shall be:
- 1. Plan strategies to reach out, nurture and affirm members and non-member women;
 - 2. Encourage and inspire Young Adult Members, ages eighteen (18) to forty (40), to join, participate actively and work in the organization;
 - 3. In collaboration with other commissions, develop programs and plan activities of special interest to younger women;
 - 4. Plan strategies designed to involve non-member women and younger women in training and enrichment activities;
 - 5. Develop a Skills Bank;
 - 6. Plan and conduct The Tanner Turner Memorial Services for deceased life members at the Quadrennial Convention;
 - 7. Prepare and circulate model programs of welcome for new members and awards for others, and prepare and circulate a Life Membership Booklet as provided within these bylaws;
 - 8. Prepare and distribute a Life Members Booklet, as provided in Article VIII of these bylaws;
 - 9. Establish guidelines for the organization to recognize Associate members with twenty-five (25) years or more of continuous, meritorious service to the organization; and
 - 10. Select deserving students for scholarship aid.
- b. *Commission Members.* The members of the Commission on Membership and Recruitment shall consist of the Third Vice President, the Member-At-Large, the Corresponding Secretary, seven (7) Episcopal Supervisors and twenty (20) At-Large- Members appointed by the President. The twenty At-Large-Members shall consist of a representative from each of the twenty (20) Episcopal Districts, with at least three (3) of the At-Large-Members being Episcopal Third Vice Presidents.

- Section 7. **Commission Meetings**. The commissions shall meet at least two (2) times per year, with at least one (1) of the meetings held at the site of the Executive Board. Additional meetings may be called by the President, as needed.
- Section 8. **Committees of Commissions**. A commission may create committees or task forces consisting of its members to facilitate the commission's work.
- Section 9. **Telephone Conference Calls**. Commissions may meet by telephone conference calls. However, the results of any action taken by telephone conference call shall be mailed within fifteen (15) days immediately to all Commission members and shall be made a part of the minutes of the next meeting of the Commission.
- Section 10. **Removal of Appointees**. Any person appointed to a Commission by the President may be removed by the President for non-performance, upon the President's written notification to the person.

Article XII – Meetings

Meetings shall be authorized to be conducted through electronic means so long as all members can simultaneously hear each other and participate during the meeting.

Article XIII - General Fiscal Policies

- Section 1. **Sources of Funds**. The sources of funds for the organization's fulfillment of its responsibilities shall be the general church budget, assessments of Episcopal Districts, monies received through special emphases and meetings, voluntary pledges, gifts, etc., annuities and other forms of investments, and offerings.
- Section 2. **Single Treasury**. A single treasury shall be maintained for the receipt and disbursement of funds of the Connectional WMS.
- Section 3. **Financial Policies**. The President shall propose policy for review and action by the Commission on Administration and provide for the implementation, within such policies, of the financial, accounting, insurance, property management, investment and money management systems and related services for the Connectional WMS.
- Section 4. **Episcopal Assessments**. Each Episcopal District shall transmit its assessments to the Connectional organization in accordance with the procedures and policies established by the Commission on Administration and adopted by the Executive Board.
- Section 5. **Auditing of Books**. Accounts of the organization shall be annually audited by a Certified Public Accountant as provided for herein under the duties of the Treasurer. This audit/audit renew shall be adopted at the subsequent Executive Board meeting.

Article XIV - Publications

- Section 1. **Magazine**. A magazine, which shall be prepared and published by the Editor on behalf of the organization, shall be owned and published by the organization. All funds received from the publication of the magazine shall belong to the organization.

Section 2. **Mission Study Program**. The *Yearbook* and accompanying study materials, prepared and published by the Promotion and Missionary Education Director on behalf of the organization, shall be owned and published by the organization. All funds received from the publication of the *Yearbook* and accompanying study materials shall belong to the organization.

Section 3. **Other Publications**. Any other publications, prepared and produced with funds of the organization, shall be owned and published by the organization. All funds received from such publications shall belong to the organization.

Article XV - Office

The headquarters of the Women's Missionary Society shall be in Washington, D.C., or such other place as the Quadrennial Convention shall determine.

Article XVI - Amendments

These bylaws may be amended as set forth in the *Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society*.

Article XVII - Parliamentary Authorities

The rules contained in *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*, latest edition, shall govern this organization in all cases to which they are applicable and to which they are not inconsistent with these bylaws, the *Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society* and *The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*

Article XVIII - Application of Provisions

Unless otherwise provided in the Episcopal, Conference and Local Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society, the provisions herein shall apply to such organizations.

Article XIX - Missionary Benediction

The Missionary Benediction shall be: "In the Name of the Triune God, May the Spirit of Christian Missions Enter Every Heart. This We Ask in Jesus' Name. Amen."

**Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Episcopal Bylaws**

Article I - Name

In each Episcopal District there shall be an organization known as the Episcopal Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Article II - Responsibilities

To fulfill the purpose of the organization, the responsibilities of the Episcopal District shall be to:

- a. Assist the Connectional in assuring that the plans, programs and objectives of the Women's Missionary Society are being fulfilled, through the programs, activities and initiatives of the Conference, or its Areas, and Local organizations;
- b. Serve as the liaison between the Connectional, Conference, and Local organizations, ensuring communications regarding programs and policies from the Connectional are disseminated in a timely and adequate manner;
- c. Facilitate the partnering of the Episcopal District with state and community agencies and resources;
- d. Coordinate, unify and harmonize the work of the Conferences, by receiving, compiling and forwarding reports between the Connectional and the Conferences;
- e. Develop and maintain cooperative relationships with the Connectional, Conference and Local organizations and the general church;
- f. Develop and implement a public policy advocacy program consistent with the Connectional, at the state and local levels, and coordinate the advocacy program for the Episcopal District;
- g. Cooperate with the Conference and Local organizations to respond financially in support of the organization;
- h. Develop and monitor annual budget and ensure financial policy is adequate and fair;
- i. Recommend to the Connectional the needs and goals of the Episcopal District, its Conference and Local Levels;
- j. Facilitate the Episcopal District's commitment to mission volunteers for work throughout the church, for short term or other assignments;
- k. Coordinate study programs and related events for the Episcopal District;
- l. Approve any Episcopal District-wide appeals;
- m. Develop materials, in cooperation with the Conference Levels, to assist Conferences, or their Areas, or Local Societies;
- n. Develop and conduct leadership training sessions for officers and others in leadership development, and produce related training materials;
- o. Develop forums and other sessions to support and strengthen the work of the Conference, or its Areas, and the Local Societies;
- p. Periodically monitor, review and evaluate programs, initiatives and other work of the Conference or its Areas, and the Local Societies;
- q. Propose to the Conferences a plan to review, monitor and report on implemented programs and activities and the progress toward meeting the goals of Connectional in the Episcopal District;

- r. Maintain accurate and adequate records;
- s. Make a report of its activities during the quadrennium to the Quadrennial Convention; and
- t. Sponsor special events for the Episcopal District, when appropriate.

Article III - Voting Membership

The voting membership of the Episcopal District shall consist of the past and present Episcopal Supervisors, past Connectional WMS Presidents, the Episcopal President, the Episcopal Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, the elected Episcopal officers, the past Episcopal Presidents **and Episcopal YPD Directors**, the Conference Presidents, the Conference Directors of the Young People's and Children's Division, Life Members, any Connectional officer residing in the Episcopal District and at least three (3) delegates from each Conference as determined by the Conference.

Article IV - Elected and Appointed Officers; Duties

Section 1. **Elected Episcopal Officers**. The Episcopal organization shall elect the First Vice President, Second Vice President, Third Vice President, Recording Secretary, Assistant Recording Secretary, Corresponding Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Historiographer-Statistician, Director of Promotion and Missionary Education, Parliamentarian, Worship Director and Member-At- Large. Elected officers shall be elected by ballot at the annual Episcopal Meeting.

Section 2. **Appointed Episcopal Officers**. The Bishop of the Episcopal District shall appoint the Episcopal President and Episcopal Director of the Young People's and Children's Division.

Section 3. **Prerequisites and Qualifications to Hold Office**. All officers must be in good and regular standing **with their Conference and Local Societies**.

Section 4. **Attendance at Meetings**. All elected and appointed officers are expected to attend all meetings of which they are a part by virtue of their office.

Section 5. **Term; Limitation**. Each elected and appointed officer shall serve a term of one (1) year and not more than eight (8) years in the same office. Any person serving as an elected or appointed Episcopal officer for sixteen (16) years, regardless of the number of elected or appointed offices held, shall be ineligible to hold another elected or appointed Episcopal office.

Section 6. **Outgoing Officers**. Outgoing officers shall arrange for the transfer of records, books, papers and property belonging to the Episcopal organization within a month of leaving office.

Article V- Duties of Officers

Section 1. **Episcopal President**. The Episcopal President shall:

- a. In cooperation with the Episcopal Supervisor establish partnerships with Conference Presidents to accomplish the mission and purpose of the Connectional and Episcopal District, to carry out the programmatic functions and responsibilities throughout the Episcopal District and to facilitate the financial support for the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference organizations;
- b. In conjunction with the Episcopal Supervisor, submit a report for each Connectional Executive Board Meeting concerning the work of the Episcopal District;

- c. Plan and conduct an Annual Mission Institute designed and developed to:
 - 1. Meet the needs of the membership of the Episcopal District and is in harmony with the purpose, plans and objectives of the Connectional;
 - 2. Encourage women to participate in the total life and work of the Women's Missionary Society and support them in assuming positions of responsibility and leadership; and
 - 3. Meet the needs and interests of women, encourage and support spiritual growth, mission outreach, and social action; promote the purpose of the Connectional.
- d. Schedule periodic meetings with Conference Presidents to ensure programmatic and financial functions and responsibilities of the Conference are being carried out, and communicate the same to the Episcopal Supervisor;
- e. Work with the Episcopal Supervisor to establish financial policies, build budgets and encourage the support of the financial objectives of the Connectional by the Conference and Local Levels;
- f. Preside over the Episcopal Executive Board Meetings; and
- g. Perform other duties and responsibilities appropriate for the Episcopal Level, as provided for by the Connectional President.

Section 2. **Episcopal Director of the Young People's and Children's Division.** The duties and responsibilities of the Episcopal Director of the Young People's and Children's Division shall be to:

- a. Unify, in cooperation with the Episcopal Supervisor and Episcopal President of the Young People's and Children's Division, the mission program of the Episcopal District with the cooperation of the Conference Directors and Conference Presidents of the Young People's and Children's Division; and
- b. Perform other duties, as appropriate for the Episcopal District, as provided for the Connectional Director of the Young People's and Children's Division.

Section 3. **Duties and Responsibilities of Other Officers.** The duties of the First, Second and Third Vice Presidents, Recording Secretary, Assistant Recording Secretary, Corresponding Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, Historiographer-Statistician, Member-At-Large, Parliamentarian and Worship Director shall be as provided, and appropriate for the Episcopal Level, for the designated Connectional Officers.

Article VI- Executive Board

Section 1. **Composition.** The Episcopal Executive Board shall be composed of the past and present Episcopal Supervisors, the Episcopal President, past Episcopal Presidents, elected Episcopal officers, the Episcopal Director and President of the Young People's and Children's Division, any Connectional officers residing in the Episcopal District, one Life Member, and the Conference Presidents and Conference Directors of the Young People's and Children's Division, and two (2) or three (3) At-Large-Members elected from each Conference. At least one of the At-Large-Members per conference must be a Life Member. The terms of the At-Large-Members from each Conference shall be staggered with one member serving a one (1) year term and the other member serving a two (2) year term (if three, provide for a three-year term). The At-Large-Members may be re-elected by their conference; however, no At-Large- Member shall serve for more than four (4) years. Conferences shall elect the At-Large- Members during the Conference Annual Meeting.

Section 2. **Meeting.** The Executive Board shall meet at least annually. Its duties shall be as provided, and appropriate for the Episcopal Level, for the Connectional Executive Board. The actions of the Executive Board shall be in accordance with the policies of the Quadrennial Convention, the Connectional Executive Board and organization and the constitution and bylaws of the organization.

Article VII- Commissions

Section 1. **Responsibilities of Commissions and Chairs.** The responsibilities of the commissions and chairs or coordinators of the commissions shall be as provided in the Connectional Bylaws, but as appropriate for the Episcopal Level.

Section 2. **Commission on Administration.**

- a. **Duties.** The Commission on Administration shall be chaired by the Episcopal President and its duties shall be to:
 1. Ensure communications regarding programs and policies from the Connectional are disseminated timely and adequately;
 2. Maintain accurate and adequate records;
 3. Receive reports and monitor progress of other Episcopal Commissions;
 4. Receive recommendations for programming and policies from the Connectional and coordinate appropriate program activities;
 5. Develop and monitor annual budget;
 6. Ensure financial policy is adequate and fair;
 7. Establish program initiatives;
 8. Set guidelines for programs;
 9. Respond to Connectional requests, as needed or required;
 10. Oversee any proposed amendments or revisions of the constitution and bylaws, and report any proposed amendments or revisions to the Connectional as provided in Article XIII of the Constitution and Article XV of the Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society;
 11. Establish a Nominating Committee and oversee its work; and
 12. Design and conduct training for officers and others, and develop related training materials.
- b. **Members.** The members of the Commission on Administration shall be the Episcopal President, the First Vice President, the Second Vice President, the Third Vice President, the Recording Secretary, the Assistant Recording Secretary, the Corresponding Secretary, the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary, the Episcopal Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, Episcopal Director of Promotion and Missionary Education, the Historiographer- Statistician, the Worship Director, the Member-At-Large, the Parliamentarian, Conference Presidents, and a Local President from each Conference appointed by the Episcopal President. The Episcopal Supervisor shall serve as an ex-officio member.

Section 3. **Commission on Christian Social Action.**

- a. **Duties.** The Commission on Christian Social Action shall:
 1. Review, adopt and sponsor social action programs recommended by the Connectional organization;
 2. Identify, study and address issues affecting communities in the Episcopal District;

3. Plan educational activities to help families improve family life;
 4. Partner with community agencies and organizations involved in eradicating poverty and hunger;
 5. Plan opportunities for engagement in the struggles and challenges of people of the world;
 6. Encourage advocacy for improving the quality of life, especially for women and children; and
 7. Provide opportunities for members to understand, work with and become members of organizations as Church Women United, Bread for the World, National Council of Negro Women, World Federation of Methodist and Uniting Church, Black Women's Agenda, Religious Network for the Equality of Women, Children's Defense Fund, Balm in Gilead and the United Nations.
- b. *Members.* The members of the Commission on Christian Social Action shall be the First Vice President, Coordinator; a Local President from each Conference; and five (5) At-Large-Members with experience and expertise in legislation or public affairs, rural or special missions, health and housing, family life; affiliated and ecumenical groups. The Local Presidents and the At-Large-Members shall be appointed by the Episcopal President.

Section 4. **Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.**

- a. *Duties.* The Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation shall:
1. Encourage and support spiritual formation and development;
 2. Develop resource material and design activities for spiritual growth and enrichment;
 3. Conduct annual institutes;
 4. Discover and develop ability of persons in the performing and creative arts;
 5. Promote the use of creative arts for enrichment and well-being;
 6. Raise visibility and awareness of the organization;
 7. Create awareness of the responsibilities of Christians, corporate and individual, for peace and justice; and
 8. Encourage advocacy for improving quality of life, especially for women and children.
- b. *Members.* The members of the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation shall be the following: the Second Vice President, Coordinator, the Historiographer-Statistician, the Director of Promotion and Missionary Education, the Worship Director, Chair of the Missionary Magazine and a Local President from each Conference appointed by the Episcopal President.

Section 5. **Commission on Membership and Recruitment.**

- a. *Duties.* The Commission on Membership and Recruitment shall:
1. Plan strategies designed to involve non-member women and Young Adult Members, ages eighteen (18) to forty (40), in training and enrichment activities;
 2. Develop programs and plan activities of special interest to Young Adult Members;
 3. Maintain a Skills Bank developed by the Conferences;
 4. Prepare and conduct memorial services (The Tanner Turner Memorial Service for deceased members of the Episcopal District);
 5. Seek deserving students for scholarship aid; and

6. Prepare and circulate model programs of welcome for new members and awards for others.
- b. *Members.* The members of the Commission on Membership and Recruitment shall consist of the Third Vice President, Coordinator, Member-At-Large, Corresponding Secretary, a Local President from each Conference appointed by the President and three (3) At-Large-Members, appointed by the President, with skills and expertise in public relations, marketing and computer technology.

Section 6. **Commission Meetings.** The commissions shall meet at the call of the Commission Chair or Coordinator and the Episcopal Leadership.

Section 7. **Telephone Conference Calls.** Commissions may meet by telephone conference calls. However, the results of any action taken by telephone conference call shall be mailed immediately to all commission members and shall be made a part of the minutes of the next meeting of the commission.

Article VIII- Application of Connectional Bylaws

Unless otherwise provided in the Episcopal Bylaws, the provisions of the Connectional Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society shall be applicable.

Article IX - Parliamentary Authorities

The rules contained in *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*, latest edition, shall govern the proceedings of the organization in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with this constitution and bylaws and *The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*.

Article X - Amendments

These bylaws may be amended as set forth in the *Constitution of the Women's Missionary Society*.

**Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Conference Bylaws**

Article I - Name

In each Conference there shall be an organization named the Conference Women's Missionary Society, a component of the Episcopal Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Article II - Responsibilities of Conferences

Section 1. **Conference Responsibilities; Functions.** The responsibilities of the Conference organizations shall be to:

- a. Work with the Local Societies, through Areas if so determined as provided herein, in developing programs to meet the needs and interests of women and the concerns and responsibilities of the Women's Missionary Society and the church;
- b. Promote the plans and responsibilities of the Connectional and Episcopal Women's Missionary Society;
- c. Encourage working partnerships with the church, other organizations and agencies to address community issues and struggles;
- d. Act as liaison between Episcopal organizations, Areas where they exist and Local Societies.
- e. Develop appropriate and useful networks with women's organization; and
- f. Respond promptly to requests from the Connectional and Episcopal Women's Missionary Society.

Article III - Operational and Structural Framework

Section 1. **Relationships.** The Conference organization is directly related to the Connectional Women's Missionary Society, Episcopal organizations and Local organizations.

Section 2. **Establishment of Areas.** A Conference may establish Areas, after a determination by the Conference, that Areas would promote a more efficient and effective method for the Conference to conduct its business. Any established Area is a unit of the Conference organization, and is not a separate and distinct organization of the Women's Missionary Society. Areas shall be governed by the provisions in Article IX of these bylaws.

Section 3. **Local Presidents Council.** A Conference without Areas may establish a Local Presidents Council. The Conference President shall serve as the chair of the council.

Section 4: **Sustentation.** The expenses of the Conference President are to be paid by the Conference Level. The expenses of the Area Chairpersons are to be paid by the Area Level.

Article IV - Membership

Section 1. **Members.** Members shall be as defined in the *Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society* and whose Local Societies are within the geographical boundary of the Conference.

Section 2. **Voting Membership**. All elected Conference officers, elected delegates, Life Members, Local Presidents, Local and Area Directors of the Young People's and Children's Division, Area Chairpersons, if they exist, any Connectional or Episcopal Officer residing in the Conference, and all other members enrolled and presenting credentials properly signed are eligible to vote. The Recording Secretary of the Conference shall keep an accurate roll of members.

A member may become enrolled and eligible to vote by:

1. Paying Local, Area and Conference dues, where it applies
2. Registering with the Conference;
3. Presenting Conference credentials certified by the Local Pastor and Local WMS President; and
4. Attending the Conference.

Section 3. **Prerequisites and Qualifications to Run for Office**. All members must attend at least one (1) Annual Conference Meeting during a quadrennium to run for a Conference office, and shall be in good and regular standing in her local organization.

Section 4. **Young Adults Transition**. Persons at age eighteen (18), who are no longer a member of the Young People's and Children's Division, may become a member of the Conference Women's Missionary Society.

Section 5. **Transfer To Another Conference**. A member in good and regular standing on the Conference Level, upon moving to another locality and presenting a letter of recommendation from the Conference President, is entitled to full membership in the Conference into which she is moving.

Section 6. **Elected Delegates**. Elected Delegates from each Local Society shall become members immediately following their approval by the Conference Credentials Committee and added annually to the Conference roll.

Section 7. **Number of Delegates**. Each Local Society is entitled to one (1) delegate for every fifteen (15) members or a fraction thereof to the Annual Conference Meeting.

Section 8. **Quadrennial Delegates**. The Recording Secretary of the Conference shall keep an accurate roll of members. Only those who have been members for four (4) or more consecutive years shall be eligible to be elected delegates to the Quadrennial Convention. Persons who transition to the WMS with uninterrupted time as a YPDer shall be eligible to be elected delegate to the Quadrennial Convention after two (2) consecutive years as active WMS members. They shall be active participants on all levels and have attended at least two (2) Annual Conference Meetings.

Article V - Conference Officers

Section 1. **Elected Officers**. The elected officers of the Conference shall be the Conference President, First Vice President, Second Vice President, Third Vice President, Recording Secretary, Assistant Recording Secretary, Corresponding Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Historiographer- Statistician, Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, Parliamentarian, Worship Director and Member-At-Large.

Section 2. **Term; Limitation.** All Conference officers shall be elected for a one (1) year term. The officer may be re-elected and hold office for eight (8) years in the same office. Any person serving as an elected Conference officer for a total of sixteen (16) years, regardless of the number of Conference offices held, shall be ineligible to hold another elected Conference office.

Section 3. **Time of Election.** The Conference officers shall be elected by ballot at each Annual Conference Meeting except in the year of election of delegates to the Quadrennial Convention. They shall assume their duties immediately after installation.

Section 4. **Vacant Office.** If a Conference office becomes vacant by reason of death or resignation or removal, the Conference President shall appoint a qualified replacement (after consulting with the Episcopal Supervisor and Episcopal President). If the office of Conference President becomes vacant and neither the First, Second or Third Vice Presidents are willing to step up to the office of Conference President, the Episcopal Supervisor shall appoint a qualified replacement (in consultation with the Episcopal President); officers appointed as replacements shall serve until elections at the next Annual Conference Meeting.

Article VI - Conference Meetings

Section 1. **Annual Meeting.** There shall be an Annual Conference Meeting at which Conference officers are elected. There shall be no election or appointment of officers at the Annual Conference Meeting preceding the Quadrennial Convention, unless as provided in this Section 1.

Conferences holding their Annual Meeting during the year of, but preceding the Quadrennial Convention, shall elect delegates during the third year of the quadrennium and elect officers during the Annual Conference Meeting of the fourth year of the quadrennium. Officers elected in these Conferences shall assume their offices immediately after the Quadrennial Convention. The Conference President shall serve as leader of the Conference delegation.

Section 2. **Executive Board.** The Executive Board shall meet at least twice a year, and be composed of the elected Conference officers, Life Members, Local Presidents, Connectional and Episcopal officers residing in the Conference, three (3), five (5), or seven (7) At-Large-Members elected at the Annual Meeting, and the Area Chairpersons, if any.

Article VII - Duties of Officers

Section 1. **Conference President.** The Conference President shall:

- a. Preside at all meetings of the Executive Board and other official meetings of the Conference;
- b. Be an ex-officio member of all commissions and such other committees as may be necessary to the conduct and development of the organization;
- c. Have supervision and direction of the work of the Conference Level;
- d. Chair the Commission on Administration;
- e. Have the authority to fill all vacancies occurring in all offices during the interim of the Conference Convention subject to the approval of the Episcopal Supervisor and the Executive Board;
- f. Appoint members to the Conference Commissions, providing for the appointment of at least 10% of the positions to be filled by young women ages 40 and younger;

- g. Supervise the work of the Areas; and
- h. Make a report to the Episcopal Convention.

Section 2. **First Vice President.** The First Vice President shall:

- a. Perform the duties of the President in the absence or disability of the President;
- b. Serve as Coordinator of the Commission on Christian Social Action; and
- c. Serve as Chair of the Program Committee in Consultation with the President.

Section 3. **Second Vice President.** The Second Vice President shall:

- a. Perform the duties of the Conference President, in the absence, disability or resignation of the Conference President and First Vice President; and
- b. Serve as the Coordinator of the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.

Section 4. **Third Vice President.** The Third Vice President shall:

- a. Perform the duties of the Conference President, in the absence, disability or resignation of the Conference President, First Vice President and Second Vice President; and
- b. Serve as the Coordinator of the Commission on Membership and Recruitment.

Section 5. **Recording Secretary.** The Recording Secretary shall:

- a. Maintain accurate minutes and records of all proceedings of the official meetings of the Conference, its Conference Convention and its Executive Board;
- b. Keep an accurate, updated roll of the membership of the Conference, and provide such information to the Episcopal and Connectional organizations; and
- c. Send names of conference elected officers (including addresses, zip codes and telephone numbers) to the Episcopal and Connectional organizations.

Section 6. **Assistant Recording Secretary.** The Assistant Recording Secretary shall assist the Recording Secretary in the keeping of all records and in the absence of the Secretary shall perform her duties.

Section 7. **Corresponding Secretary.** The Corresponding Secretary shall conduct the necessary correspondence and send quarterly and annual blanks (including statistics) to the Local Level.

Section 8. **Treasurer.** The Treasurer, who shall be bonded in an amount as determined by the Commission on Administration, shall:

- a. Receive the funds from Local Societies and from the Areas as the Conference shall determine;
- b. Write, sign and mail checks countersigned by the President or write, sign and mail checks authorized for payment by voucher signed by the President; and
- c. Submit itemized statements of all finances to the Commission on Administration, the Conference Convention and to the Executive Board and signed vouchers by the President and Treasurer for all issued checks.

Section 9. **Financial Secretary.** The Financial Secretary shall:

- a. Maintain an independent set of records of all financial transactions and
- b. Assist with the work in concert with the Treasurer.

- Section 10. **Director of the Young People's and Children's Division.** The Director of the Young People's and Children's Division shall:
- Plan and supervise the work of the Conference Young People's and Children's Division;
 - Provide regular reports to the Conference regarding the work and activities of the Conference Young People's and Children's Division.
- Section 11. **Promotion and Missionary Education Director.** The Promotion and Missionary Education Director shall:
- Promote and interpret the work of the Connectional that the Episcopal organization supports;
 - Promote mission education opportunities, including but not limited to mission studies, Area and Local mission opportunities and encounters;
 - Promote and distribute mission education literature, including the *Yearbook* and related study materials;
 - Plan Mission and Training Institutes;
 - Promote, utilize and select audio visual materials to aid in the interpretation of the mission work; and
 - Serve as the Conference contact person for Area, if any, and Local Directors of Promotion and Missionary Education.
- Section 12. **Historiographer-Statistician.** The Historiographer-Statistician shall:
- Have full responsibility of gathering the data pertaining to the history of the Local organizations;
 - Request all facts and figures relating to the Local and Conference Levels and compile them; and
 - Report such historical data to the Episcopal and Connectional organizations.
- Section 13. **Worship Director.** The Worship Director shall serve the Conference by providing appropriate and creative styles and types of worship experiences/devotions and assist in planning worship experiences for the Conference.
- Section 14. **Member-At-Large.** The Member-At-Large shall serve on the Commission on Membership and Recruitment, work with the Young Adult Members, ages eighteen (18) to forty (40), and be responsible for promoting volunteer mission programs.
- Section 15. **Parliamentarian.** The Parliamentarian shall give advice to the Conference President on the proceedings, during a meeting, and when requested, to another member.

Article VIII - Conference Commissions

- Section 1. **Commission on Administration.** The Commission on Administration shall:
- Ensure that communication regarding programs and policies from the Connectional and Episcopal Levels is appropriately and adequately distributed;
 - Maintain accurate and adequate records of its program and financial activities;
 - Receive reports from and monitor the progress of other conference commissions;
 - Receive recommendations for programming and policies from the Connectional and Episcopal Levels and coordinate appropriate program activities;
 - Develop and monitor the annual budget of the Conference;
 - Ensure financial policy is adequate and fair;

- g. Respond to Connectional and Episcopal requests, as needed or required;
- h. Oversee the work of a Nominating Committee; and
- i. Serve as the Constitution and Bylaws Committee.

The members of the Conference Commission on Administration shall be the Conference President, as Chair, First Vice President, Second Vice President, Third Vice President, Recording Secretary, Assistant Recording Secretary, Corresponding Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, Historiographer-Statistician, Worship Director, Member-At-Large, Parliamentarian, the Local President and any Area Chairpersons, where they exist.

Section 2. **Commission on Christian Social Action**. The Commission on Christian Social Action shall:

- a. Review, adopt and sponsor social action programs recommended by the Connectional and Episcopal organizations;
- b. Study issues affecting communities in the Conference and develop appropriate strategies to address the issues;
- c. Plan educational activities to help families improve family life;
- d. Partner with community agencies and organizations involved in eradicating poverty and hunger; and
- e. Encourage membership and partnership with organizations as: Church Women United, National Council of Negro Women, Black Women's Agenda, etc.

The members of the Conference Commission on Christian Social Action shall be the First Vice President, as Coordinator, five (5) to fifteen (15) Local Presidents appointed by the Conference President, three (3) At-Large-Members representing family life issues, three (3) At-Large-Members representing global health and housing issues, three (3) At-Large-Members representing legislative or public affairs issues, three (3) At-Large-Members representing rural and special missions issues, and three (3) At-Large-Members representing affiliated and ecumenical group issues. The At-Large-Members shall be appointed by the Conference President.

Section 3. **Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation**. The Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation shall:

- a. Encourage and support spiritual formation and development;
- b. Develop resource material and design activities for spiritual growth and enrichment;
- c. Conduct annual mission and training institutes;
- d. Discover and develop activities in the performing and creative arts;
- e. Promote the use of the arts for enrichment and well-being;
- f. Focus on improving school performance of young people;
- g. Raise visibility and awareness of the Women's Missionary Society;
- h. Create awareness of the responsibilities of Christians, corporate and individual, for peace and justice; and
- i. Encourage advocacy for improving quality of life, especially for women and children.

The members of the Conference Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation shall include the Second Vice President, as Coordinator, the Promotion and Missionary Education Director, the Historiographer-Statistician, the Worship Director, five (5) to fifteen (15) Local Presidents, and five (5) to fifteen (15) At-Large-Members, with expertise in writing, resource development, computer technology, and education library science. The Local Presidents and

At-Large-Members shall be appointed by the Conference President.

Section 4. **Commission on Membership and Recruitment**. The Commission on Membership and Recruitment shall:

- a. In collaboration with other commissions, develop programs and plan activities of special interest to Young Adult Members, ages eighteen (18) to forty (40);
- b. Plan strategies designed to involve both women in the church who are not members and Young Adult Members in training and enrichment activities;
- c. Develop a Skills Bank of its members;
- d. Provide advice, training and program models for Conference and Local Levels;
- e. Provide for membership nurture and outreach; and
- f. Plan and conduct the Tanner Turner Memorial Services for all deceased members who remained on the Conference roll until their demise.

The members of the Conference Commission on Membership and Recruitment shall be the Third Vice President, as Coordinator, the Corresponding Secretary, the Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, Member-At-Large, five (5) to fifteen (15) Local Presidents and two (2) At-Large-Members with expertise in public relations and computer technology. The Local Presidents and At-Large-Members shall be appointed by the Conference Presidents.

Section 5. **Commission Meetings**. The Conference Commissions shall meet at least twice annually, with one (1) of the meetings being held at the site of the first Executive Board Meeting of the Conference year. Special Meetings of a Conference Commission may be called by the President, as needed.

Article IX - Areas

Section 1. **Areas**. If a Conference determines the establishment of Areas will assist in the effective and efficient conduct of its business, the Conference may establish Areas which shall:

- a. Be organized as geographical divisions of the Conference for the purpose of giving information, assistance and providing inspiration to the Local Societies within its boundaries;
- b. Serve as a liaison between the Local and Conference Level;
- c. Stimulate the work of the Local Societies through workshops, panels, institutes, dialogues, discussion groups, visual aids, etc. under the direction of the Conference Commissions; and
- d. Assure that monies raised shall be utilized for the cause of missions. Pay assessments at such time and in such amount as determined by the Conference.

Section 2. **Appointment of Area Chairpersons and Area Directors**. The Conference President shall appoint and supervise all Area Chairpersons. The Conference Director of the Young People's and Children's Division shall, in consultation with the Conference President, appoint all Area Directors of the Young People's and Children's Division.

Area Chairpersons and Area Directors shall act as an interface between the Conference leadership and Local Societies. For this purpose, each Area Chairperson and Area Director shall be assigned a geographical area, as determined by the Conference President, and shall relate to the Local Society leadership in that area. Area Chairpersons and Area Directors shall have the specific responsibility of promoting the program goals and objectives of the Women's

Missionary Society, within their area of responsibility.

Section 3. **Area Coordinating Council or Elected Officers.** At the first call of an Area Meeting, the Area Chairperson shall hold an election for ten (10) persons to serve on the Area Coordinating Council, or shall hold elections for officers consistent with the Conference elected offices. The Coordinating Council shall oversee the planning and coordination of the work for the Area and fulfill other duties as provided herein.

Section 4. **Area Meetings.** Meetings of the Area shall be held quarterly per year, or at such other times as agreed upon by its members.

Article X - Application of Connectional Bylaws

Unless otherwise provided in the Conference Bylaws, the provisions of the Connectional Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society shall be applicable.

Article XI - Parliamentary Authorities

The rules contained in *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*, latest edition, shall govern the proceedings of the organization in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with this constitution and bylaws and *The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*.

Article XII - Amendments

These bylaws may be amended as set forth in the *Constitution of the Women's Missionary Society*.

**Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Local Bylaws**

Article I – Name

Section 1. Name; Limitation

- a. *Congregational Organization.* In each local church there may be a Local organization known as the () Women's Missionary Society of () African Methodist Episcopal Church, a part of the Conference Level. There shall be only one (1) Local Society in each church.
- b. *Intercongregational Organization.* There may be a Local organization formed for women from two or more congregations, which are too small to form a congregational organization and have no congregational organization. The organization shall be known as the () Women's Missionary Society of () African Methodist Episcopal Churches, a part of the Conference Level. The name of a Local Society should be one that reflects the faithful and dedicated work of a female Supervisor, or Local Society member, living or deceased. No Local Society shall be named for an associate member or Itinerant Elder, living or deceased.

Article II - Responsibilities of the Local Society

To accomplish the mission and purpose of the Women's Missionary Society, the Local Society shall commit to:

- a. *Witness.* Participate in the ministry of the organization beyond its congregation(s), know its community and partner with agencies to provide needed service to the community;
- b. *Advocate.* Urge change in systems and structures which exclude and alienate, and work for peace and justice in the community;
- c. *Membership.* Encourage, recruit, affirm and motivate non-member women, of all ages, to participate in its Unit, providing an intergeneration of caring women;
- d. *Educate.* Provide opportunities to worship and study; and share yearly Study-book curriculum beyond its membership and congregation;
- e. *Stewardship.* Support financially the total program of the Women's Missionary Society.

Article III - Organizational and Structural Framework

Section 1. **Formation of Units.** Each Local Society may **establish** Units according to age groups, local interest, or geographical location, for the efficient conduct of its business. **A Unit of the Local Society may not elect officers or establish appointed positions.**

Unit Chairperson. When a Local Society forms a unit, the Local President shall appoint a chairperson of each Unit. A single congregation may establish a Local organization, or two (2) or more congregations may form an intercongregational Local organization.

Section 2. **Structural Determination.** One of the following structural models may be used by a Local Society, so as to provide flexible and alternative structures to meet the needs of the Local church community.

- a. *Team Leadership.* Elected officers shall be the President, Secretary-Treasurer, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, and Director of the Young People's and Children's

Division. Members shall work together to develop programs for Mission Education and Interpretation, Christian Social Action and Membership and Recruitment.

- b. *Traditional Leadership*. The organizational structure and elected officers shall be as the Conference and Episcopal organizations.

Section 3. **Partnership with Conference**. The Local Society shall participate in the meetings, work and activities of the Episcopal District, the Conference and the Area, if applicable, to which it is assigned.

Article IV - Membership

Section 1. **Membership**. The provisions in the Connectional Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society shall govern membership in the Local Society.

Section 2. **Ex-Officio Member**. The Pastor(s) shall be an ex-officio member(s) of the Local Society.

Article V - Meetings

Section 1. **Regular**. The Local Society shall hold at least eight (8) meetings per year or more if necessary to transact the business of the society.

Section 2. **Special**. The President upon the request of five (5) members may call special Meetings. Notice of such meetings shall be sent to each member with a statement of the business to be transacted.

Section 3. **Sustentation**. The expenses of the Local President are to be paid by the Local Level of which that officer is a member.

Article VI - Officers; Elections

Section 1. **Team Leadership or Intercongregational Organization**. This Local Society shall have [Name of Officer Positions] elected for a term of one (1) year, but may be re-elected for up to eight (8) years in the same office.

Section 2. **Traditional Leadership**. The elected officers of the Society shall be the same as for the Conference and Episcopal Levels, and shall be elected for one (1) year, but may be re-elected for up to eight (8) years in the same office.

Section 3. **Election of Officers**. All officers shall be elected by ballot, except when there is only one candidate for an office. Voting may be by a voice or hand vote, when there is one candidate for an office. A majority vote shall elect. Elections shall be held following the Annual Conference Meeting.

Article VII - Duties of Officers

Section 1. **President**. The President, working with the Executive Board, shall actively seek to advance all aspects of the work of Women's Missionary Society. She shall:

- a. Preside at all meetings of the Local Society, its Executive Board and serve as ex-officio member of all commissions or committees, where they exist;

- b. Prepare reports as necessary with other elected officers;
- c. Develop, with the Executive Board, a plan to assure the Local Society's fulfillment of its responsibilities as a part of Women's Missionary Society;
- d. Represent the Local Society in all meetings;
- e. Ensure the constitution and bylaws of the organization are duly observed and the actions are carried into effect;
- f. Appoint all committees not provided for;
- g. Sign all orders drawn on the treasury for the disbursement of funds;
- h. Serve as liaison and communicate with the Conference organization and Area, if applicable; and
- i. Chair the Commission on Administration, where one exists.

Section 2. **First Vice President.** The First Vice President, working cooperatively with the President shall:

- a. Perform the duties of the President, in her absence or disability;
- b. Become President, upon the resignation or death of the President;
- c. Chair the Program Committee, where there is one;
- d. Plan, evaluate and promote the programs of the organization, in conjunction with the President;
- e. Coordinate the public policy and legislative action of the Local Society;
- f. Perform such other duties as requested by the President; and
- g. Serve as Coordinator for the Commission on Christian Social Action, where one exists.

Section 3. **Second Vice President.** The Second Vice President, where one exists, shall:

- a. Perform the duties of the President, in the absence of the President and First Vice President; and
- b. Serve as Coordinator for the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation, where one exists.

Section 4. **Third Vice President.** The Third Vice President, where one exists, shall:

- a. Preside, in the absence of the President, First and Second Vice Presidents;
- b. Work with the President and Executive Board to determine the needs of the membership, to enlist new members and recommend ways for inactive members to participate;
- c. Nurture the current membership, and
- d. Serve as Coordinator for the Commission on Membership and Recruitment.

Section 5. **Recording Secretary.** The Secretary shall:

- a. Keep accurate minutes of all meetings of the Local Society and its Executive Board and give notice of the meetings;
- b. Serve as custodian of all records and official papers;
- c. Sign, with the President, all official papers;
- d. Keep an accurate up-to-date roll of the Local Society's membership, along with the names of officers;
- e. Perform such other duties as the President may assign from time to time;
- f. Serve on the Commission on Administration, where one exists;

- g. Provide for the gathering and preserving of historical records and documents, where there is no Historiographer-Statistician.

Section 6. **Assistant Recording Secretary.** The Assistant Recording Secretary shall assist the Recording Secretary in performing her duties and in the absence of the Recording Secretary shall perform her duties.

Section 7. **Corresponding Secretary.** The Corresponding Secretary shall prepare and conduct correspondence with members under the direction of the President.

Section 8. **Treasurer.** The Treasurer shall:

- a. Become informed concerning the financial responsibility of the Local Society;
- b. Disburse funds on order signed by the President;
- c. Account for all funds of the Local Society, and work with the Executive Board to develop a plan for receiving funds from individuals or Units on a regular basis;
- d. In consultation with the President, establish a budget for the Local Society;
- e. Make itemized financial reports to the Society at its regularly scheduled meetings; and
- f. Serve on the Commission on Administration, where one exists.

Section 9. **Financial Secretary.** The Financial Secretary shall:

- a. Maintain an independent set of records of all financial transactions and
- b. Assist with the work in concert with the Treasurer.

Section 10. **Promotion and Missionary Education Director.** The Promotion and Missionary Education Director shall:

- a. Present and carry out the Connectional programs and study programs as directed by the Conference organization;
- b. Promote mission education opportunities: mission studies, local mission opportunities, and supply material and educational resources for mission programs and projects;
- c. Promote and interpret the work of the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation supports; and
- d. Serve on the Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation, where one exists.

Section 11. **Director of the Young People's and Children's Division.** The Director of the Young People's and Children's Division shall plan and supervise the work of the young people under the Local Society. She shall provide a report of the young people's work at the regularly scheduled meetings of the Local Society.

Section 12. **Other Officers.** The Local Society may designate other Local officers as the officers provided for on the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference Levels. Such officers' duties shall be as provided in Article VII of the Conference Bylaws, but as applicable to the Local Society.

Section 13. **Annual Officer's Report.** Each elected officer shall report annually at the Local meeting prior to the Annual Conference Meeting and more often if provided in these bylaws or requested by the Local Society.

Article VIII - Executive Board

Section 1. **Membership.** The Executive Board shall consist of the elected officers, Life Members,

Chairpersons of the Units, YPD President, three (3) At-Large Members, elected annually by ballot, and any Connectional, Episcopal or Conference Officer, who is member of the congregation. The President shall preside over the meetings of the Executive Board.

Section 2. **Purpose; Duties.** The Executive Board shall set policies required for the effective and efficient functioning of the Local Society, act as the Constitution and Bylaws committee to review and propose amendments to the constitution or bylaws, and plan and facilitate programmatic activities of the Local Society. A Local Society operating under a Team Leadership structure is not required to have an Executive Board but may as an entire organization or as part of the organization fulfill the functions of the Executive Board.

Article IX - Commissions

For any Local Society operating under the Traditional Leadership structure, the Local Society may establish the same Commissions as provided for on the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference Levels.

Section 1. **Commission on Administration.** The duties of the Commission shall be the same as for the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference Levels, but as applicable to the Local Society. Members of the Commission on Administration shall be the President, serving as chair, First Vice President, Second Vice Presidents, Third Vice President, Recording Secretary, Assistant Recording secretary, Corresponding Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Local Director of the Young People's and Children's Division, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, any other elected officers of the Local Society and Commission Coordinators.

Section 2. **Commission on Christian Social Action.** The duties of the Commission shall be the same as the duties for the commission at the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference Levels but as applicable to the Local Society. The members of the Commission on Christian Social Action shall be At-Large-Members, appointed by the President representing interests in family life, housing, affiliated groups, rural and special missions and legislation.

Section 3. **Commission on Mission Education and Interpretation.** This Commission shall have the same duties as the commission of the Connectional, Episcopal or Conference Levels. Members of the relations, computer technology and education library science, Promotion and Missionary Education Director, Worship Director, and the Historiographer-Statistician

Section 4. **Commission on Membership and Recruitment.** The Membership and Recruitment Commission shall have the same duties as the committee on the Connectional, Episcopal, and Conference Levels. At-Large-Members shall be appointed by the President and possess skills and experience relative to public relations, computer technology and banking.

Article X – Application of Connectional Bylaws

Unless otherwise provided in the Local Bylaws, the provisions of the Connectional Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society shall be applicable.

Article XI - Amendments

These bylaws may be amended as set forth in the Constitution of the Women's Missionary Society.

Article XII - Parliamentary Authorities

The rules contained in *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*, latest edition, shall govern the proceedings of the organization in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with this constitution and bylaws and *The Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*.

**Young People's and Children's Division
Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Connectional Bylaws**

Article I - Name

There shall be an organization named the Connectional Young People's and Children's Division, a division of the Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Article II - Purpose

The purpose of the organization shall be to:

- a. Provide meaningful resources, training and guidance in all areas of church life which encourage full participation in the mission programs and activities of the entire church and this organization;
- b. Provide specific training in Evangelism, Christian Social Relations and Education programs designed to increase knowledge of the African Methodist Episcopal Church History and the Scriptures;
- c. Facilitate and support opportunities for leadership experiences in the church and society;
- d. Enable growth in stewardship in the church;
- e. Advocate for the integrity of childhood and the dignity of all children and youth in our religious, civic and political structures;
- f. Create linkages, establish work synergies and devise schedules to effectively implement and administer meaningful programs and activities for all levels and units of the organization; and
- g. Foster a community, in which children, youth and young adults know each other by name, minister to each other and partner in servicing and witnessing for Jesus Christ.

Article III - Operational and Structural Framework

Section 1. **Review of Policies.** Policies of the organization shall be subject to the review and approval of the Commission on Administration of the Women's Missionary Society.

Section 2. **Connectional Finance.** This organization shall be financed through the Women's Missionary Society and the organization's fiscal year shall be in accordance with the fiscal year of the Women's Missionary Society. All monies shall be deposited with, and budget requests shall be submitted to, the connectional treasury of the Women's Missionary Society.

Section 3. **Structure.** This organization shall be composed of the Episcopal, Conference, and Local Young People's and Children's Division of the Women's Missionary Society, and such Areas as determined by a Conference. The organizations shall be grouped on a territorial basis, with the same boundaries established for the Episcopal, Conference and Local Women's Missionary Society, and such boundaries established by a Conference for its Areas.

Article IV - Membership

Membership shall consist of the following:

Section 1. **Regular.** Any young person of the church ages two (2) to twenty-six (26) years of age, who is active and in good and regular standing in their Local organization.

Section 2. **Associate.** Any young men or women who become Itinerant Deacons shall be associate members. Associate members shall be without voting privileges and ineligible to hold office.

Section 3. **Ex-Officio.** Ex-officio members shall be the Bishops, Episcopal Supervisors, Commission Chair of Global Witness and Ministry, President of the Connectional Women's Missionary Society, and the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference YPD Directors.

Article V - Components of the Young People's and Children's Division

The organization shall consist of:

Section 1. **Sunbeams.** The Sunbeams shall consist of children ages two (2) to six (6) years of age, preschool to primary.

Section 2. **Allen Stars.** The Allen Stars shall consist of Children ages seven (7) to twelve (12).

Section 3. **Youth.** The Youth shall consist of females and males of the ages of thirteen (13) through seventeen (17) years of age.

Section 4. **Young Adults.** Young Adults shall consist of females and males of the ages of eighteen (18) years to twenty-six (26) years.

Section 5. **Promotional Exercises.** Any component may provide for promotional exercises for its members.

Article VI - Connectional Director

Section 1. **Duties of Director.** The Connectional Director shall have supervision over and direct the work of the organization. She shall have on file in her office the names and addresses of Connectional Officers and Connectional Committee Chairpersons, Episcopal Directors and Episcopal Presidents, Conference Directors and Officers to implement the programs of the organization and, in consultation with the Women's Missionary Society, strive to have an organized Young People's and Children's Division in every church where there is a Women's Missionary Society. The Connectional Director shall plan and direct mission programs for children, youth and young adults within the framework of the purpose of the Women's Missionary Society.

Section 2. **Required Signature.** The signature of the Connectional Director shall be affixed to all correspondence of the organization.

Section 3. **Financial Accountability.** The Connectional Director shall receive all monies designated for the organization and account for such monies with the assistance of the Financial Secretary. Upon the accounting for such funds, the Connectional Director shall transfer all such monies and copies of supporting documentation to the connectional treasury housed with the Women's Missionary Society. The Connectional Director shall be responsible for disbursements for the organization, upon the presentation of vouchers to the connectional treasury.

Article VII - Quadrennial Convention

Section 1. **Authority.** The Quadrennial Convention of the Women's Missionary Society shall convene every four (4) years, and shall include the Young People's and Children's Division. The Quadrennial Convention shall be the highest legislative authority of Women's Missionary Society and shall deal with all matters which are necessary in the pursuit of the purpose, goals and objectives of the organization. All amendments to these bylaws shall be approved by the Quadrennial Convention.

The time and place of the Quadrennial Convention shall be determined in accordance with the Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society.

Section 2. **Voting Membership.** The voting members of the Quadrennial Convention, all of which shall be in good and regular standing in their Local organizations, shall consist of:

- a. Elected and Appointed Connectional Officers;
- b. Chairpersons of the Standing Committees;
- c. Episcopal and Conference Presidents; and
- d. Two (2) voting delegates (ages thirteen (13) to twenty-six (26)) from each Conference.

Section 3. **Selection of Voting Delegates.** Delegates to the Quadrennial Convention shall be selected in accordance with the provisions of the Conference Bylaws.

Section 4. **Duties of Delegates.** The duties of delegates shall be to:

- a. Attend all sessions of the convention (if for a serious reason a voting delegate is unable to attend, the alternate delegate shall serve in his or her place); and
- b. Prepare a report on the actions of the convention to be presented to constituencies he or she represents.

Section 5. **Registered Observers.** Registered **observers** may attend the convention at no additional expenses to the organization. They may participate in the programs and attend the sessions of the convention. They shall have no voice and no vote.

Article VIII - Officers; Election Procedures

Section 1. **Elected Officers.** The elected officers of the Connectional shall be: President, First Vice President, Second Vice President, Third Vice President, Recording Secretary, Assistant Recording Secretary, Financial Secretary, Communications Secretary, Parliamentarian, Historiographer-Statistician, Worship Director, Editor of YPD Newsletter, and Associate Editor.

Section 2. **Nominations for Elected Office.** All nominations for elected offices shall be conducted as provided in Article XI, Section 7 of these bylaws. No person shall be listed on the slate of nominees who fails to meet the qualifications as provided by Section 5 herein.

Section 3. **Election of Officers; Ballots.** Officers shall be elected at the Quadrennial Convention by a majority of votes cast. No person shall be permitted to hold more than one elected or appointed office beyond the Local Young People's and Children's Division. No person shall be permitted to hold the same office for more than two (2) consecutive quadrennials (eight (8) years).

All elections shall be by electronic or paper ballot except when there is only one candidate for an office. When there is only one candidate for an office, the vote for that office may be by a show of hands or voice vote.

Section 4. **Term of Office.** The officers shall be elected to serve for a term of four (4) years or until their successors are elected. Their terms of office shall begin immediately following the adjournment of the Quadrennial Convention at which they are elected.

Section 5. **Qualifications to Run for Office.** Any person seeking an elected office shall:

- a. Be active, and in good and regular standing, in his or her Local organization;
- b. Have registered and participated in a Connectional training institute or retreat, or served as a delegate to a Quadrennial Convention prior to the time in which he or she runs;
- c. Be active on and support the Episcopal, Conference, and Area, if applicable;
- d. Be at least 13 years of age, but not older than 22 years of age at the time of election; and
- e. Present credentials, as required by the Nominating Committee, bearing the signature of the Episcopal Director and Episcopal Supervisor.

Section 6. **Appointed Officers.** Appointed officers shall be chairpersons of standing committees of the organization. Such officers shall be appointed by the Connectional President in consultation and agreement with the Connectional Director and Episcopal Districts in which the officers hold membership. Anyone appointed chairperson of a standing committee shall be at least thirteen (13) years of age and active on all levels of the organization.

Section 7. **Outgoing Officers.** Outgoing officers shall transfer all records, books, papers and property belonging to the organization to incoming officers within one (1) month of the Quadrennial Convention. Under the direction of the Director, outgoing officers shall communicate with incoming officers within six (6) weeks of the transfer of the organization's records, books, papers and property.

A transition meeting shall be held within six (6) months of the Quadrennial Convention to provide an opportunity for the Director and elected officers to communicate their shared vision.

Section 8. **Disqualification/Removal from Office.** Any officer, elected or appointed, not performing his or her duties may be subject to removal from office.

Any elected officer not performing his or her duties shall be notified in writing by the Connectional Director, with a copy to the Connectional President and the President of the Women's Missionary Society. If such failure to perform continues for a period of ninety (90) days after notification, the matter shall be referred to the Executive Board for action. The Executive Board may remove the elected officer from office for failure to execute her duties and responsibilities as provided in Article X, Section 1.

Any appointed officer not performing his or her duties may be removed by the Connectional President, in consultation and agreement with the Connectional Director, upon the written notification from the Connectional President and Director.

Article IX - Duties of Elected Officers

The elected officers of the organization shall perform the duties prescribed herein.

Section 1. **President**. The President shall:

- a. Preside over Executive Board Meetings and the Quadrennial Convention;
- b. Prepare the agenda, in consultation and agreement with the Connectional Director, for the Executive Board Meetings, Quadrennial Conventions and other official meetings of the organization;
- c. Submit reports to the Quadrennial Convention;
- d. Represent the organization at functions and meetings of the African Methodist Episcopal Church;
- e. Serve as an ex-officio member of Women's Missionary Society;
- f. With the Connectional Director, appoint task forces or committees for necessary duties to carry on the work of the organization which are not otherwise assigned in these bylaws;
- g. Serve as ex-officio member of all committees as may be necessary for the conduct and development of the organization; and
- h. Be at least 18 years of age. One needs to be at least eighteen (18) years of age to be a voting member of the General Board.

Section 2. **First Vice President**. The First Vice President shall:

- a. Serve in the absence of the President, assuming the responsibilities of the same;
- b. Support the President by accepting, when possible, duties and responsibilities assigned by the same; and
- c. Serve as Chairperson of the Program and Planning Committee.

Section 3. **Second Vice President**. The Second Vice President shall:

- a. Serve in the absence of the President and First Vice President;
- b. **Serve as chairperson of the Self-Denial Program**; and
- c. Serve as Coordinator of the Standing **and Special** Committees.

Section 4. **Third Vice President**. The Third Vice President shall:

- a. Serve in the absence of the President, First Vice President and Second Vice President.
- b. Serve as the chairperson of the International **Awareness** Committee;
- c. Represent Districts 14-20 when a representative is unable to attend Connectional YPD functions;
- d. Work with the Episcopal District YPD Presidents and Directors from Districts 14-20 to coordinate Connectional YPD projects and activities; and
- e. Be a member in good and regular standing of the organization in Districts 14-20.

Section 5. **Recording Secretary**. The Recording Secretary shall:

- a. Record and keep accurate minutes of all Executive Board Meetings, Quadrennial Conventions and other official meetings of the organization;
- b. Be responsible for all official correspondence for the Executive Board Meetings and Quadrennial Conventions; and

- c. Under the direction of the Connectional President and Connectional Director, perform all other duties common to the office.

Section 6. **Assistant Recording Secretary**. The Assistant Recording Secretary shall:

- a. Assist the Recording Secretary in keeping all records; and
- b. In the absence of the Recording Secretary shall perform such duties.

Section 7. **Financial Secretary**. The Financial Secretary shall:

- a. Keep an accurate record of all monies received and disbursed by the organization;
- b. Serve as **Vice**-Chairperson of the Budget and Financial Estimate Committee and Finance Chair at official meetings of the organization; and
- c. With the Connectional Director, transfer monies received to the connectional treasury and submit vouchers for disbursement to the same.

Section 8. **Communications Secretary**. The Communications Secretary shall:

- a. Be responsible for the youth section of the Women's Missionary Magazine and all other A.M.E. Church publications such as *The Christian Recorder* and *Journal of Religious Education*;
- b. Stimulate interest for subscriptions to periodicals of the African Methodist Episcopal Church;
- c. Correspond with the members of the Connectional Executive Board in the interim of board meetings.

Section 9. **Parliamentarian**. The Parliamentarian shall:

- a. Ensure that the Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society and the Bylaws of the Young People's and Children's Division, the current *Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church* and *Robert's Rules of Order*, latest edition, are followed at all meetings;
- b. Serve as Vice Chairperson of the Constitution and Bylaws Committee; and
- c. Interpret any rules during the course of meetings.

Section 10. **Historiographer-Statistician**. The Historiographer-Statistician shall:

- a. Have responsibility for gathering data pertaining to the history of the organization;
- b. Conduct a census each Quadrennial;
- c. Keep an accurate enrollment of the members of the organization; and
- d. Through the Director, provide such historical data and membership enrollment to the Historiographer-Statistician of the Connectional Women's Missionary Society.

Section 11. **Worship Director**. The Worship Director shall:

- a. Coordinate the planning of worship services for the Executive Board Meetings and Quadrennial Conventions with the members of the Program Planning Committee;
- b. Serve as a member of the Program Planning Committee; and
- c. Promote special times and events for meditations and devotions/worship experiences at meetings.

Section 12. **Editor of the YPD Gazette**. The Editor of the YPD Gazette shall:

- a. Serve as Editor-in-Chief of the organization's publication under the supervision of the Connectional Director; and
- b. Work with the Episcopal and Conference Associate Editors of the Gazette to gather news and articles from across the Connectional YPD.

Section 13. **Associate Editor of the YPD Gazette**. The Associate Editor of the YPD Gazette shall work in cooperation with the Editor in receiving and editing news and articles from Districts 14-20, under the supervision of the Connectional Director.

Article X - Executive Board

Section 1. **Duties of the Board**. The duties of the Executive Board shall be to:

- a. Serve as the interim governing body of the organization between Quadrennial Conventions by carrying on the business of the organization, within the policies of the convention and reporting its actions to the subsequent Quadrennial Convention; except that it may not take any action that is reserved exclusively for the Quadrennial Convention or that is in conflict with the Quadrennial Convention;
- b. Perform the duties prescribed by the constitution and bylaws;
- c. Periodically review the work of the organization, and through the Director and President, make such recommendations to the Commission on Administration of the Connectional Women's Missionary Society as it deems wise;
- d. Review such reports as prepared by various officers, committees and the Episcopal, Conference, or Local organizations;
- e. Determine whether any elected officer is unable or unwilling to serve;
- f. Fill vacancies occurring for elected officers: Should an elected officer become unable or unwilling to fulfill his or her respective duties, the board shall be empowered to declare said office vacant and to elect a successor to complete the unexpired term. Such successor may be eligible for election to the same office at the next Quadrennial Convention if he or she is within the proper guidelines established by these bylaws. To choose a successor, the Board shall use the following guidelines:
 - i. The nominee(s) must meet age limits as required by the bylaws;
 - ii. The first runner-up from the Quadrennial Convention for the vacated position will be invited to run for said office;
 - iii. The vacant position will be publicized through the periodicals and communications networks of the Women's Missionary Society and the organization; and
 - iv. The Executive Board will elect the replacement with a simple majority vote.
- g. Approve and prepare a yearly budget for the organization, under the direction of the Connectional Director and President, for transmittal to the Commission on Administration of the Women's Missionary Society.

Section 2. **Composition of Executive Board**. The Executive Board shall be composed of:

- a. Elected officers;
- b. Chairpersons of the standing committees;
- c. Episcopal presidents;
- d. Immediate past president of the organization, as an ex-officio member; and

- e. The director, Episcopal directors and the president of the women's missionary society, in an advisory capacity.

Section 3. **Meetings.** The Executive Board shall meet annually, or at such other specially called meetings as determined by the Connectional president or Connectional director, in consultation and agreement with each other. A majority of the members of the Executive Board shall constitute a quorum.

Article XI - Standing Committees

The following committees are established to implement and facilitate the goals, objectives, programs and projects of the organization.

Section 1. **Program Planning.** This committee shall:

- a. **Plan and implement** study courses on the Bible, the *Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*, Black Studies, **Constitution and Bylaws**, and current mission study themes;
- b. **Develop** programs and courses which enhance leadership skills to prepare children, youths and young adults for leadership roles;
- c. **Provide** creative opportunities on all levels for children, youths and young adults to experience the awareness of God's presence in their midst and respond to that presence with devotion and commitment; and
- d. **Sponsor** programs and activities which help members transition from the organization to the larger community of organizations in the Women's Missionary Society and the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Section 2. **Membership Recruitment and Outreach.** This committee shall:

- a. Plan strategies to reach out, nurture and **affirm children**, youths and young adults to join and actively participate in the organization;
- b. Develop programs and other events to motivate members and other young people to be strong witnesses in Christian faith by participating in mission endeavors and other ministries; and
- c. Prepare and circulate model programs of welcome for new members and awards for others.

Section 3. **Budget and Financial Estimates.** This committee shall:

- a. Under the supervision of the Connectional YPD Director and Connectional WMS President, prepare a Quadrennial Budget request for transmittal to the Commission on Administration of the Connectional WMS; and
- b. **Promote financial literacy through various initiatives.**

Section 4. **Constitution and Bylaws.** This committee shall:

- a. Study, analyze and revise suggested recommendations for changes to the constitution and bylaws received from the Conferences through the Episcopal Districts with the signature of the Episcopal Supervisor, **Episcopal WMS President, and Episcopal YPD Director**; and
- b. Submit recommendations for revisions of the constitution and bylaws to the Constitution and Bylaws Committee of the Connectional WMS, at such times and in such time periods as provided in the Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society.

Section 5. **International Awareness**. This committee shall:

- a. Assist the Third Vice President in working with the Episcopal District YPD Presidents and Directors from Districts 14-20 to coordinate Connectional YPD projects and activities; and
- b. Provide opportunities for members from all Episcopal Districts to exchange ideas, programs, and objectives.

Section 6. **Campus Ministry**. This committee shall:

- a. Develop resources for AME college and university students; and
- b. Emphasize the traditions and spiritual values of the AME Church and provide opportunities for the involvement of AME college and university students; and
- c. Counsel and/or direct students to the appropriate agencies when they are faced with personal challenges.

Section 7. **Nominating**. This committee shall:

- a. Select and present nominees and report these nominees to the Quadrennial Convention;
- b. At least seven (7) months prior to the Quadrennial Convention call for nominations through a notice published in an official periodical of the Women's Missionary Society (and any other appropriate publication). Such notice shall also indicate how a nomination form may be obtained. Nomination forms shall be sent to Executive Board members and Episcopal Supervisors for distribution to interested persons. The nomination form shall request individuals to give biographical data and other information which will aid in the selection of candidates. On receipt of all information the Nominating Committee shall meet and select final candidates meeting the qualifications herein and whose names will be placed on the ballot according to the procedures within these bylaws; and
- c. Create and provide the necessary credential forms to all prospective nominees for office. Such credential forms shall be returned by prospective nominees, bearing the signature of the Episcopal Director and Supervisor, no later than ninety (90) days prior to the Quadrennial Convention.
- d. Prepare a ballot of nominees for office to be presented at the Quadrennial Convention. Nominations shall not be accepted from the floor of the Quadrennial Convention. Members of the committee shall be ineligible for nomination to any position to be filled.

Section 8. **Evaluation**. This committee shall:

- a. Distribute and utilize evaluation sheets to survey the strengths and weaknesses of each meeting; and
- b. Make recommendations for improvement.

Section 9. **Voter Registration**. This committee shall develop a program that promotes and encourages young people to register to vote and actively participate in the democratic process.

Section 10. **Monique Gonzales Memorial**. This committee shall plan and conduct a memorial service, during each Leadership Training Institute (LTI) and Quadrennial Convention, for deceased members of the organization.

- Section 11. **Technology.** This committee shall assist with the implementation and improvement of technology services. The committee shall provide training to the YPD on all levels. Each level is encouraged to establish a Technology Committee.
- Section 12. **Special Committees.** The Connectional YPD Director may establish special committees to assist and serve the needs of the organization.
- Section 13. **Selection of Committee Members.** Each Episcopal District shall be represented on each standing and special committee. No Episcopal District shall have more than one member, and the terms of the members' appointments shall be consistent with the terms of office of the elected and appointed persons as provided in Article VIII, Section 4 of these bylaws.

Article XII - Leadership Training Institute

The Executive Board shall plan an annual Leadership Institute designed to:

- a. Provide experiences for learning and leadership development;
- b. Equip participants to grow as whole persons, develop their potential and prepare them for leadership in missions and ministry;
- c. Establish a network for preparing and supporting youths and young adult leaders in the African Methodist Episcopal Church; and
- d. Motivate participants to practice interdependence and teamwork, returning to their church communities assisting with leadership development.

Article XIII - Self-Denial Week

The week of May 7-14, known as the Founder's Week of the organization, shall be observed as Self-Denial Week and carried out in local churches through the organization. Throughout the week, the members of the Local organization may sponsor essay contests, worship programs, community service projects and other similar activities.

Section 1. Every Self-Denial Week shall be featured with one or more service projects and a Self-Denial Offering.

Section 2. The Self-Denial Offering shall be used annually for a scholarship and other awards.

Article XIV - Parliamentary Authorities

The current Constitution and Bylaws of Women's Missionary Society, the *Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church* and *Robert's Rules of Order*, latest edition, shall govern the proceedings of the organization.

Article XV - Amendments

These bylaws may be amended only as provided in Article XIII, Section 2 of the Constitution of the Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church and shall not be in conflict with Bylaws of the Connectional Women's Missionary Society or the *Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church*.

Article XVI - Organization Colors

The colors shall be forest green and white or black and white. Green is symbolic of growth and Christian vitality, white represents purity, light and faith, and black is symbolic of the strength of our African heritage.

Article XVII - Application of Connectional Bylaws to the Episcopal, Conference and Local Organizations

Unless otherwise provided in the Episcopal, Conference and Local Bylaws, the provisions herein shall apply to such organizations of the Young People's and Children's Division.

**Young People's and Children's Division
Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Episcopal Bylaws**

Article I - Name

In each Episcopal District, there shall be an organization known as the Episcopal Young People's and Children's Division of the Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Article II - Purpose

To accomplish the purposes of the organization, each Episcopal organization shall:

- a. Coordinate and unify the work of the Conference organization, including the receiving and compiling of reports from the Conferences and providing necessary reports to the Connectional organization;
- b. Develop responsible and visionary leadership through training and experience;
- c. In partnership with the Connectional and Conferences organizations, develop networks for timely and effective communication among all levels and units;
- d. Foster cooperative and interdependent relationships among the Connectional, Episcopal, Conference and Local organizations; and
- e. Provide opportunities for the financial support of the total program of the organization.

Article III - Operational and Structural Framework

Section 1. **Connectionalism**. This organization shall be the liaison between the Connectional, Conference and Local Young People's and Children's Divisions, providing a means by which to foster relationships and encounters of the organization to enhance the accomplishments of the purposes of the organization.

Section 2. **Reporting**. All reports required by the Connectional organization shall be provided to the Episcopal Director and President for review and transmission to the Connectional Director.

Section 3. **Evaluations**. The Episcopal Director, in conjunction with the Episcopal Supervisor and Episcopal President, shall establish a process for a periodic evaluation of current mission programs being carried out in the Episcopal District in light of the changing needs of children, youths and young adults in our church and society.

Article IV - Voting Members

Section 1. **Members**. Members of the Episcopal organization shall be:

- a. Episcopal Officers;
- b. Chairpersons of Episcopal Standing Committees;
- c. Connectional Officers, elected or appointed, who reside in the Episcopal District;
- d. Conference Presidents; and
- e. All elected delegates.

Section 2. **Ex-Officio Members.** The Episcopal Supervisor, Episcopal President, Episcopal Director and Conference Directors of the Young People's and Children's Division, who are members of the Women's Missionary Society, shall be ex-officio members of the Episcopal organization.

Article V - Episcopal Director

Section 1. **Appointment.** The Episcopal Director shall be appointed by the presiding bishop. Her name must be registered in the office of the Connectional Young People's and Children's Division no later than thirty (30) days after her appointment has been certified.

Section 2. **Qualifications for Episcopal Director.** The Episcopal Director shall demonstrate experience with, and a commitment to, children, young people and young adults and their challenges.

Section 3. **Duties of Episcopal Director.** The Episcopal Director shall:

- a. Have supervision and direction of the work of the Episcopal Young People's and Children's Division;
- b. Work with the Conference Directors and keep in close communication with all Episcopal officers to implement the total program of the organization;
- c. Receive and deposit Episcopal funds in the name of the organization and submit regular reports to the Episcopal Level;
- d. Be responsible for preparing and issuing reports annually, after the Annual Meeting, to the Episcopal Supervisor. The Episcopal Supervisor shall forward any required reports to the Office of the Connectional Director; and
- e. Keep in close communication with the Connectional Director and maintain close relations with the Episcopal Supervisor and Episcopal President.

Article VI - Officers; Duties; Elections

Section 1. **Requirements To Hold Office.** Any member of the Episcopal organization, who is also active in the Conference, Local and Area organizations, if any, may hold office if he or she is at least thirteen (13) years, but not older than twenty-five (25) years of age **at the time of election**.

Section 2. **Elected Officers; Duties.** The elected Episcopal officers, and their respective duties, shall be the same as for the Connectional Young People's and Children's Division **except the Third Vice President.**

The Third Vice President shall:

- a. Serve in the absence of the President, First Vice President, and Second Vice President;
- b. Serve as the Chairperson of the Membership Recruitment and Outreach Committee; and
- c. Work with the Conference Third Vice Presidents to facilitate recruitment and retention within the District.

Section 3. **Appointed Officers; Duties.** The Episcopal President in consultation with the Episcopal Director shall appoint the Chairpersons of the Standing Committees, whose duties shall be the same as the Connectional Chairpersons.

Section 4. **Election of Officers; Terms.** Officers shall be elected annually at the Episcopal Meeting, except for the year preceding the Quadrennial Convention in which there shall be no election. No

person, elected or appointed, shall be permitted to hold the same office more than two (2) consecutive quadrennials.

Section 5. **Attendance at Meetings.** All elected and appointed officers are expected to attend all Episcopal and Connectional meetings whenever possible. An officer's local church shall be responsible for the expense of such officer's attendance at meetings of the Episcopal and Connectional organizations.

Article VII - Executive Board

Section 1. **Composition.** The Episcopal Executive Board shall be composed of:

- a. Elected Episcopal Officers;
- b. Chairpersons of Standing Committees;
- c. Conference Presidents;
- d. Connectional Officers, elected or appointed, who reside in the Episcopal District;
- e. The Episcopal Director and Conference Directors, in an advisory capacity; and
- f. The immediate past Episcopal President, as an ex-officio member.

Section 2. **Meetings and Agendas.** The Episcopal President, in consultation with the Episcopal Director, shall determine the agenda of Executive Board Meetings. The Episcopal President shall preside over the Executive Board Meeting.

Article VIII - Standing Committees

The Standing Committees, including committee duties, of the Episcopal organization shall be the same as the Connectional Young People's and Children's Division.

Article IX - Leadership Training and Young People's Institute

The Episcopal organization shall hold an annual Leadership Training and Young People's Institute. Said institute shall be planned by the Executive Board under the chairmanship of the First Vice President.

Article X - Delegates

The Episcopal President, by virtue of the office held, shall be the only Episcopal delegate to the Quadrennial Convention.

Article XI - Application of Connectional Young People's and Children's Division Bylaws

Unless otherwise provided herein, the Connectional Young People's and Children's Division Bylaws shall be applicable.

**Young People's and Children's Division
Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Conference Bylaws**

Article I - Name

In each conference there shall be an organization named the Conference Young People's and Children's Division of the Women's Missionary Society of the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

Article II - Purpose

Each Conference organization, including any Areas established, in partnership with the Connectional and Episcopal organizations shall assist the Local Level to fulfill the purposes of the organization.

Article III - Operational and Structural Framework

Section 1. **Connectionalism**. The Conference, with the assistance of its Areas, shall be the connecting link between the Episcopal, Local and the Connectional organizations.

Section 2. **Determination of Need for Areas**. In consultation with the Local Directors, the Conference Director shall make a determination of a need for Areas. If its determined that Areas are needed, the Conference Director, with the assistance of Local Directors, may organize Areas which shall be governed by Article XII of these bylaws.

Section 3. **Organization of Areas**. Areas shall be organized by a Conference to help unify the work of the Local and Conference organizations and to stimulate the same through workshops, seminars and other activities and media, so as to be a connecting link for a Local to the Conference organizations. A Conference shall organize an Area as geographically practical as possible. Areas shall work interdependently with the Local and Conference Levels to fulfill the purpose of the organization.

Article IV - Conference Director

Section 1. **Election of Director; Term of Office**. The Conference Director shall be elected by the organization yearly at its annual meeting, except in the year of the Quadrennial Convention, in accordance with the provisions of the Bylaws of the Conference Women's Missionary Society. However, any person elected Conference Director shall not serve more than two (2) consecutive quadrennials, or eight (8) years.

Section 2. **Qualifications for Director**. Anyone who is elected Conference Director shall demonstrate experience with, and a commitment to, children, young people and young adults and their challenges. In determining the qualifications of any person seeking this office, the Conference Women's Missionary Society may obtain comments from young persons.

Section 3. **Duties of Director**. The duties and responsibilities of the Conference Director shall be to:

- a. Oversee and direct the work of the Conference;
- b. Ensure accurate accounts and statistics are maintained on behalf of the Conference and timely provided to the Episcopal;
- c. Receive and deposit funds in the name of the Conference;
- d. Make regular reports to the Conference organization concerning the work of the Conference, with observations and recommendations affecting the organization; and
- e. Appoint, after consultation with the Conference President, the Area Directors.

Article V - Officers in General; Elections

Section 1. **Elected and Appointed Officers**. The officers of this organization shall be, and their duties, the same as for the Connectional and Episcopal organizations, unless otherwise provided herein. No person shall be permitted to hold more than one (1) elected or appointed office beyond the Local Level or to hold the same office more than two (2) consecutive quadrennials, or eight (8) years.

Section 2. **Election of Officers**. Officers shall be elected annually, except for the year of election of delegates to the Quadrennial Convention.

Section 3. **Qualifications to Run for Office**. Any person seeking an elected office shall:

- a. Be active and in good and regular standing in his or her local organization;
- b. Be active on and support the Conference and Area, if applicable;
- c. Be at least 13 years of age but not older than 25 years of age at the time of election; and
- d. Present credentials as required by the Nominating Committee.

Section 4. **Disqualification/Removal**. Any Conference officer, elected or appointed, not performing his or her duties, including but not limited to, a failure to attend Annual and Quarterly Meetings or to keep in close communications with the Conference Director, may be subject to removal from office.

An elected officer not performing his or her duties shall be notified in writing by the Conference Director, with a copy to the Conference President. If such failure to perform continues for a period of sixty (60) days after notification, the matter shall be referred to the Executive Board for action. The Executive Board may remove the elected officer from office for failure to execute his or her duties and responsibilities as provided in these bylaws.

Any appointed officer not performing his or her duties may be removed by the Conference President, in consultation and agreement with the Conference Director, upon the written notification from the Conference President and Conference Director.

Article VI - Duties of Officers

The elected officers of the Conference shall perform the duties prescribed herein:

Section 1. **President**. The President shall:

- a. Preside over Executive Board Meetings and the Conference meetings;
- b. Prepare the agenda, in consultation and agreement with the Conference YPD Director, for

- the Executive Board Meetings and Conference meetings;
- c. Submit reports to the Conference YPD;
- d. Represent the organization at functions and meetings of Conference;
- e. Serve as an ex-officio member of Conference WMS Executive Board;
- f. With the Conference Director, appoint task forces or committees for necessary duties to carry on the work of the Conference which are not otherwise assigned in these bylaws;
- g. Serve as ex-officio member of all committees as may be necessary for the conduct and development of the Conference. and

Section 2. First Vice President. The First Vice President shall:

- a. Serve in the absence of the President, assuming the responsibilities of the same;
- b. Support the President by accepting, when possible, duties and responsibilities assigned by the same; and
- c. Serve as Chairperson of the Program and Planning Committee.

Section 3. Second Vice President. The Second Vice President shall:

- a. Serve in the absence of the President and First Vice President;
- b. Promote the Self-Denial Program and the yearly activities for Self-Denial Week; and
- c. Serve as Coordinator of the Standing and Special Committees.

Section 4. Third Vice President. The Third Vice President shall:

- a. Serve in the absence of the President, First Vice President and Second Vice President.
- b. Serve as the chairperson of the Membership Recruitment and Outreach Committee; and
- c. Work with the Episcopal Third Vice President to facilitate recruitment and retention within the Conference.

Section 5. Recording Secretary. The Recording Secretary shall:

- a. Record and keep accurate minutes of all Executive Board Meetings and Conference Meetings;
- b. Be responsible for all official correspondence for the Executive Board Meetings and Conference Meetings; and
- c. Under the direction of the Conference President and Conference Director, perform all other duties common to the office.

Section 6. Assistant Recording Secretary. The Assistant Recording Secretary shall:

- a. Assist the Recording Secretary in keeping all records; and
- b. In the absence of the Recording Secretary shall perform such duties.

Section 7. Financial Secretary. The Financial Secretary shall:

- a. Keep an accurate record of all monies received and disbursed by the Conference;
- b. Serve as Chairperson of the Budget and Financial Estimate Committee and Finance Chair at official meetings of the Conference; and
- c. With the Conference Director, transfer monies received to the Conference treasury and submit vouchers for disbursement to the same.

Section 8. Communications Secretary. The Communications Secretary shall:

- a. Correspond with the members of the Conference Executive Board in the interim of Board Meetings; and
- b. Manage the Conference Social Media accounts.

Section 9. **Parliamentarian**. The Parliamentarian shall:

- a. Ensure that the Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society and the Bylaws of the Young People's and Children's Division, the current *Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church* and *Robert's Rules of Order*, latest edition, are followed at all meetings;
- b. Serve as Chairperson of the Constitution and Bylaws Committee; and
- c. With the assistance of the Conference Director, interpret any rules during the course of meetings.

Section 10. **Historiographer-Statistician**. The Historiographer-Statistician shall:

- a. Have responsibility for gathering data pertaining to the history of the Conference;
- b. Keep an accurate enrollment of the members of the Conference; and
- c. Keep account of all members and persons registering and attending each Quarterly and Annual meeting;
- d. Make a list and record of local churches in the Conference and the members of the Local division; and
- e. Be responsible for making a statistical report to the Conference and Episcopal Director.

Section 11. **Worship Director**. The Worship Director shall:

- a. Coordinate the planning of worship services for the Conference YPD;
- b. Serve as a member of the Program Planning Committee; and
- c. Promote special times and events for meditations, devotions, and worship experiences at meetings.

Section 12. **Associate Editor of the YPD Gazette**. The Associate Editor of the YPD Gazette shall:

- a. Assist the Episcopal Associate Editor of the YPD Gazette in soliciting articles for the Gazette; and
- b. Submit articles to the Episcopal Associate Editor, under the supervision of the Conference Director.

Article VII - Standing and Special Committees

These committees of the Conference organization shall be the same as the Standing and Special Committees of the Connectional and Episcopal Levels, with the same duties as provided for such Standing and Special Committees. Committee Chairpersons will work interdependently with their Episcopal and Connectional counterparts to fulfill the duties of chairpersons and to carry out the programmatic functions and responsibilities of the Standing and Special Committees.

Article VIII - Members; Voting Privileges

Section 1. **Members**. Members of the Conference are as provided in Article IV of the Connectional Bylaws of the Young People's and Children's Division.

Section 2. **Requirements to Vote or Hold Office**. Any member, active in the local organization, and who is at least 13-25 years of age, shall be allowed to hold office and to vote.

Section 3. **Voting Membership**. Voting members of the Conference shall be Elected Officers of the Conference, Connectional and Episcopal Officers residing within the Conference, Area, Local Presidents and delegates who have registered and attended at least one (1) annual convention of the Conference and are active in the local organization.

Article IX - Delegates

Section 1. **Delegates and Alternates**. There shall be two (2) elected delegates and two (2) alternates from each Conference to the Quadrennial Convention. The Conference President shall be the leader of the Conference delegation.

Section 2. **Requirements for Delegates**. Members of the Conference who wish to become a delegate or an alternate to a Quadrennial Convention must be active in their Local organizations, and their Area organizations if applicable, and present credentials bearing the signature of their Local Director and Area Director, if applicable.

Article X - Executive Board

Section 1. **Composition**. The Conference Executive Board shall be composed of:

- a. Elected Officers of the Conference;
- b. Chairpersons of Standing Committees of the Conference;
- c. Area Chairpersons;
- d. Connectional and Episcopal Officers, elected or appointed, residing in the Conference;
- e. Conference Director, Area Directors and the Conference President of the Women's Missionary Society, sitting in an advisory capacity; and
- f. The immediate past president of the Conference, as an ex-officio member.

Section 2. **Meetings and Agendas**. The Conference President, in consultation with the Conference Director, shall prepare and determine the agenda of Executive Board Meetings.

Article XI - Meetings

Section 1. **In General**. Meetings of the Conference shall be held under the direction and supervision of the Conference Director and presided over by the Conference President.

Section 2. **Timing of Annual Meeting**. The annual meeting of the Conference shall be held at the time and place separate and distinct from the annual meeting of the Conference Women's Missionary Society, so the Conference Directors may participate in sessions of the Conference Women's Missionary Society.

Section 3. **Council**. The organization may hold a council to devise plans to meet the needs of the Conference. Such council shall be called by the Conference Director and presided over by the Conference President.

Article XII - Conference Areas

If a Conference organizes an Area, the Area unit shall be governed by applicable provisions of the bylaws and as provided herein.

Section 1. **Duties of the Area Director.** The Area Director shall:

- a. Meet with the Local Directors to discuss means and ways of improving the overall work of the Local and Area Levels and means of facilitating programs and activities of the Local Level; and
- b. Report to and keep the Conference Director informed of the activities, finances, recommendations and needs of the Area.

Section 2. **Area Membership.** Area membership shall consist of members as defined by the Conference Bylaws, provided such persons are members of a Local organization within the designated boundaries of such Area.

Section 3. **Area Meetings.** Meetings of the Area shall be held quarterly per year, or at such other times as agreed upon by its members, for the purpose of mission education work and/or other projects under the supervision of the Area **Director**. Local Directors may assist in the planning and holding of such meetings.

Section 4. **Area Officers.** An Area may have the same, or fewer, elected officers as the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference. If an Area decides to have less elected officers, the Area may combine the duties of two (2) or more closely related offices. Any changes to achieve fewer elected officers shall be provided in writing to the Conference Director and the Conference President.

Section 5. **Finances.** All monies collected by an Area shall be reported and provided to the Conference.

Article XIII - Application of Provisions

Unless otherwise provided herein, the Connectional Bylaws of the Young People's and Children's Division shall be applicable.

**Young People's and Children's Division
Women's Missionary Society
African Methodist Episcopal Church
Local Bylaws**

Article I - Name

There shall be an organization named the Young People's and Children's Division, in every local church where there is a Women's Missionary Society.

Article II - Purpose

The purpose of this organization shall be to implement mission programs and activities in local communities to fulfill the purpose of the organization, by providing a training ground for later Christian service to the Women's Missionary Society and the African Methodist Episcopal Church. To accomplish the purpose, the Young People's and Children's Division commits to:

- a. Come together to study the Bible, the African Methodist Episcopal Church and the Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society and Bylaws of the Young People's and Children's Division;
- b. Perform service projects in the community;
- c. Conduct and participate in workshops on Christian Social Relations and Family Life dealing with such topics as drugs and alcohol abuse, personal development, juvenile delinquency, teenage sexuality, communication, social morals, etc.;
- d. Pursue experiences for leadership development in the church and community; and
- e. Build a community of children, youth and young adults that strengthen the organization and church.

Article III - Operational and Structural Framework

Section 1. **Organizational Relationships.** A Young People's and Children's Division established under these provisions shall be amenable to the Local Women's Missionary Society.

Section 2. **Local Intercongregational.** A Local Women's Missionary Society organized as an intercongregational organization, in accordance with the *Constitution and Bylaws of the Women's Missionary Society*, shall establish an intercongregational Young People's and Children's Division. When an intercongregational Young People's and Children's Division is formed, the Local Women's Missionary Society shall provide such information through the Conference Level to the Episcopal organization. The Episcopal organization shall transmit such information to the Connectional organization.

Section 3. **Reports.** The organization shall provide yearly to the Conference Level a list of its members, the Local Director and Local Advisors.

Article IV - Local Director and Advisors

Section 1. **Election of Local Director.** The Local Director of the Young People's and Children's Division shall be elected by the Local Women's Missionary Society. The Local Director shall be an active member of the Local Women's Missionary Society. The local Pastor shall certify that a background check has been completed within the last two (2) years as required by the *Doctrine*

and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church under the Sexual Misconduct Section (page 348 of the 2021 Discipline). The Local Pastor shall be the custodian of record.

Section 2. **Selection of Local Advisors.** The Sunbeams, Allen Stars and Youth and Young Adult Auxiliary shall have youth or young adult Advisors. The Advisors shall be selected by the Local Director and approved by the Local Women's Missionary Society. Advisors must be members of the Local Women's Missionary Society, Youth and Young Adult Auxiliary or Young Adult Members, ages eighteen (18) - forty (40) years of age, of the Local Women's Missionary Society. The local Pastor shall certify that a background check has been completed within the last two (2) years as required by the *Doctrine and Discipline of the African Methodist Episcopal Church* under the Sexual Misconduct Section (page 348 of the 2021 Discipline). Local Pastor shall be the custodian of record.

Article V - Members; Voting Privileges; Dues

Section 1. **Member.** Members and classification of members shall be as provided in Article IV of the Bylaws of the Connectional Young People's and Children's Division.

Section 2. **Eligibility to Vote and Hold Office.** Any member who is at least thirteen (13) to twenty-five (25) years of age is eligible to vote and hold office.

Section 3. **Membership Dues.** The payment of dues and the time for such payment shall be determined by the organization.

Article VI - Delegates

Section 1. **Number of Delegates.** Each Local Society is entitled to one (1) delegate for every fifteen (15) members or a fraction thereof to the Annual Conference Meeting.

Article VII - Officers; Duties; Committees

Section 1. **Officers.** Officers and their duties may be the same as for the Connectional, Episcopal, and Conference officers of the Young People's and Children's Division. Officers shall be elected annually.

The organization may limit its number of elected and appointed officers, due to its size or other reasons, or use a team leadership approach permitting leadership to be shared and decisions to generally be made by consensus.

Section 2. **Committees.** Standing Committees and their duties may be the same as the Connectional, Episcopal and Conference Levels, or they may be combined or limited as appropriate. In making a decision regarding Standing Committees, the organization is encouraged to determine the committees and programs most appropriate and workable in their church community.

Article VIII - Meetings

Local meetings shall be held once a month, or at such time as determined by the members of the organization.

Article IX - Self - Denial Week

- Section 1. **Sponsorship**. The organization shall sponsor Self-Denial programs during the week of May 7-14 for the purpose of encouraging commitment to Christ and assisting in the financial support of the Connectional Christian Social Outreach.
- Section 2. **Funds**. All monies raised during Self-Denial Week shall be sent through the Area and/or Conference Levels to the Episcopal Director who shall forward such monies to the Connectional Director.
- Section 3. **Essay Contest Emphasis**. Members of the organization should be encouraged to participate in the Essay Contest which is part of the Self-Denial program.

Article X - Offering

The organization may ask for and receive the Missionary Offering of its church on each fourth Sunday. This money is to be used for mission activities and programs.

Article XI - Funds; Reports

The organization may, with the assistance of the Local Women's Missionary Society, raise their own funds and disburse the same. They shall submit, on a regular basis, such reports as required to the Local Women's Missionary Society.

Article XII - Annual Day

The organization shall sponsor an Annual Young People's and Children's Day. The program shall be educational, with the purpose of stimulating the work and increasing the membership of the organization.

Article XIII - Application of Provisions

Unless otherwise provided herein, the Connectional Bylaws of the Young People's and Children's Division shall be applicable.

APPENDIX A
AFRICAN METHODIST EPISCOPAL CHURCH ORDER OF THE WOMEN'S MISSIONARY SOCIETY

WMS Colors and Attire

- I. The colors of the Women's Missionary Society shall be white with a touch of royal blue.
- II. The Attire shall be one of the following:
 - A. All white – appropriate length suits or dresses, pant suits, white jewelry, WMS pin
 - B. White with touch of royal blue accessories, WMS pin
 - C. Life Members – all white with Life Member Stole, WMS pin
 - D. Associate Members – white or black suits with white/blue tie
- III. The colors and attire of the WMS for Districts 14 – 20 may include the leopard attire uniform – black robe, white collar and leopard skin cap. *This does not apply to District 16.*

Color Symbolism

White – symbolic of purity of life and conversation; light that shines more and more, and faith.

Royal Blue – symbolic of peace and healing Power of God; it has positive effects on the mind and body; it represents trust, loyalty, sincerity, wisdom, confidence and faith.

Leopard Skin or Leopard Skin Design Material – symbolic of grace, quickness, determination and endurance to fight sin and to defend righteousness.

APPENDIX B
AFRICAN METHODIST EPISCOPAL CHURCH ORDER OF THE WOMEN'S MISSIONARY SOCIETY

ROBING CEREMONY

THE PROCESSIONAL

Persons to be inducted, program participants, Episcopal, and
Conference Officers

THE DOXOLOGY

THE CALL TO WORSHIP

THE OPENING HYMN

THE PRAYER

THE SELECTION

THE SCRIPTURE

THE ADDRESS (On Being a Good Missionary)

THE HYMN

THE EXAMINATION OF INDUCTEES (The persons to be inducted shall be brought forward to the designated place, facing those persons who will perform the ceremony during the singing of the last verse of the hymn.) Then shall the following be said:

SPEAKER #1: It is fit and proper that we address these questions to you who desire membership in this Society. It was established in the United States of America by our illustrious founder and in this country by a group of noble Christian women.

QUESTIONER #1: Do you believe in your heart that the step you are about to take will be pleasing in the sight of God?

ANSWER: I do so believe, the Lord being my helper.

QUESTIONER #2: Do you entertain friendly feelings towards the members of the Women's Missionary Society?

ANSWER: Yes, I do, the Lord being my helper.

QUESTIONER #3: Are you prepared to abide by the Constitution and Bylaws of the African Methodist Episcopal Church, as well as those which govern the Women's Missionary Society?

ANSWER: Yes, I am prepared, the Lord being my helper.

QUESTIONER #1: The uniform we wear is not for outward show; each part of it has a special meaning in our society. We will ask you two more questions after the explanation of the uniform is explained to you.

EXPLAINER #2: The Robe—black in color, it is a symbol of the strength of our African heritage of mourning for those who persist in their rebellion against God, and who commit acts displeasing in the sight of God. (The first verse of suitable hymn is sung while a robe is displayed to the inductees.)

EXPLAINER #2: The Collar—in its whiteness symbolizes purity in life and conversation, and the whiteness of the light that shineth more and more unto the perfect day. The "V" shape of the collar represent victory over sin and confusion. The Badge—which joins them together—is an emblem of the tie which binds together the determination in the leopard, a common grief for those who offend God (The second verse of same hymn is sung while the collar and badge is displayed to the inductees.)

EXPLAINER #3: The Cap—made of the skin of a leopard and/or leopard skin design material remarkable for its grace, quickness, and endurance—is for us a symbol of determination to fight sin and to defend righteousness. (The third verse of same hymn is sung while the cap is displayed to the inductees.)

QUESTIONER #1: Do you faithfully promise to wear this uniform with honor and integrity to the Glory of God of His church, as well as for the promotion of the cause of mission?

ANSWER: This I faithfully promise, the Lord being my helper.

QUESTIONER #2: Do you promise that you will give with a willing heart and hand to the financial and spiritual welfare of the Society?

ANSWER: This I faithfully promise, the Lord being my helper.

SPEAKER #1: If you are determined by God's help to fulfill these promises which you have undertaken to observe, we shall robe you now. *(Here the robe, collar, badge, and cap shall be placed on the inductees. Each shall be robed together, then comes the collar to each, then the badge to each, finally, the cap to each. These items should be presented/placed on each by their Local or Area or Conference or Episcopal heads or a combination of the same.)*

THE OFFERING FOR MISSIONS

(During the offering for missions the inductees shall be placed in a suitable area so that those giving in the offering may congratulate them as they pass the offering table.)

THE CLOSING HYMN: (Audience forms a circle and joins hands)

THE DOXOLOGY - MISSIONARY BENEDICTION:

"In the Name of the Triune God
May the Spirit of Christian Missions
Enter Every Heart
This We Ask in Jesus' Name" Amen

NOTE: The missionary uniform should be worn at all regular meetings of the Society, on special days, i.e., Good Friday and Easter; at the funeral of a member of the Society and other official occasions or when so directed by responsible officers of the Society.

APPENDIX C

Y.P.D. Colors and Uniforms

I. The Uniforms of the Young People's and Children's Division shall be:

A. Forest Green and White

1. Young Ladies
 - a. Forest Green Skirt
 - b. Forest Green / White Blazer or Jersey
 - c. White Skirt
 - d. Y.P.D. Badge/Pin
2. Young Men
 - a. Forest Green / Khaki Trousers
 - b. Forest Green / White Blazer or Jersey
 - c. White shirt
 - d. Forest Green Tie
 - e. Y.P.D. Badge/Pin

B. Black and White

1. Young Ladies
 - a. Black Skirt
 - b. White Blouse/Blazer
 - c. Black "V" Shaped Collar
 - d. Black Cap with 3 Leopard and/or leopard skin design material Triangular Shaped Patches Attached
 - e. Y.P.D. Badge/Pin
2. Young Men
 - a. Black Pants
 - b. Black/White Blazer
 - c. White shirt with "V" shaped Leopard and/or leopard skin design material Triangular Patches Attached
 - d. Black Tie
 - e. Y.P.D. Badge/Pin

II. Uniform and Color Symbolism

Forest Green—is symbolic of growth and Christian vitality.

White—is symbolic of purity of life and conversation; light that shineth more and more, and faith.

Black—is symbolic of mourning for those who persist in their rebellion against God and who commit acts displeasing in His sight.

Collar's "V" Shape—symbolic of victory over sin and confusion.

Leopard and/or leopard skin design material Patch—symbolic of grace, quickness, determination and endurance to fight sin and to defend righteousness (Triangular in shape, symbolic of the Trinity and strength).

Badge—symbolic of the tie which binds together the determination to endure till the end.

III. Uniform Combinations

The outfits are only worn as uniforms in the combinations as listed in II. They are not to be mixed up.

"Suggest that the home districts wear one leopard patch, triangular in shape representing the Holy Trinity, symbolic of the beginning of the African Methodist Episcopal Church and the Women's Missionary Society in America."